



AMAZING CHESS ADVENTURES FOR KIDS

CHESS BRAIN GAMES FOR CHILDREN

Fun Chess Puzzles, Chess Maths, Colouring Activities & Brain Challenges



Written by KUNAL SAHA

BIRATI CHESS ACADEMY™

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www.biratichessacademy.com

Series: AMAZING CHESS ADVENTURES FOR KIDS

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Welcome to the Book

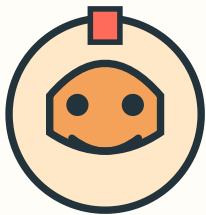
Chess Brain Games for Children is an activity book designed to make chess practice fun, colourful and rewarding. Inside, your child will meet friendly chess characters, colour original chess artwork, solve original puzzles, and explore chess-themed mathematics and brain games.

Chess activities can give children opportunities to practise concentration, planning, logical thinking, observation and problem-solving. Like any skill, chess improves gradually with regular, enjoyable practice — there is no need to rush.

This book does not require a chessboard to enjoy, although having one nearby is a wonderful bonus! Every puzzle includes a picture of the board, clear instructions, and space to write an answer. An answer key at the back of the book explains every solution in simple language.

💡 **Did you know? Chess is one of the oldest board games in the world, played and enjoyed by people of all ages for well over a thousand years!**

We hope this book brings your family many happy hours of thinking, colouring and playing together.



How to Use This Book

1. Go at your own pace

There is no time limit! Some puzzles are easy, some are tricky. Take your time with each page.

2. Use a pencil

Most activities have space to write your answer. A pencil makes it easy to try again if needed.

3. Check the Answer Key

Every puzzle number matches an entry in the Answer Key at the back of the book, with a friendly explanation.

4. Colour freely

The colouring pages are yours to enjoy — there is no right or wrong way to colour a friendly chess piece!

5. Ask for help if you like

Chess is even more fun with a friend or family member nearby to talk through tricky puzzles.

6. Have fun first

The most important rule of all: enjoy yourself. Everything else follows from there.

Think Before You Move

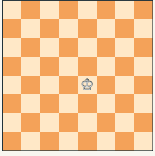
Great chess players share one habit: they think carefully before touching a piece. Here are five friendly thinking habits to practise on every page of this book.

- 1 Look at the WHOLE board, not just one piece.
- 2 Ask: is my king safe right now?
- 3 Ask: can I capture anything for free?
- 4 Ask: can my opponent capture anything of mine?
- 5 Choose your move, and only then make it.

Activity: Before you turn the page, say all five thinking habits out loud from memory. Can you remember all five?

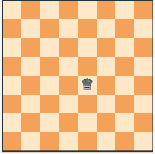
MEET THE PIECES

Get to Know Your Chess Army



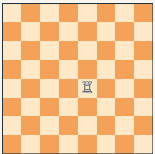
King (Priceless — protect it at all costs!)

Moves: One square in any direction (except castling).



Queen (9 points)

Moves: Any number of squares in any direction: up, down, sideways or diagonally.

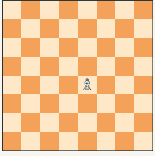


Rook (5 points)

Moves: Any number of squares up, down, left or right (straight lines only).

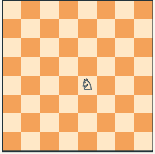
MEET THE PIECES

More Chess Friends to Meet



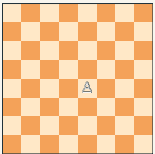
Bishop (3 points)

Moves: Any number of squares diagonally.



Knight (3 points)

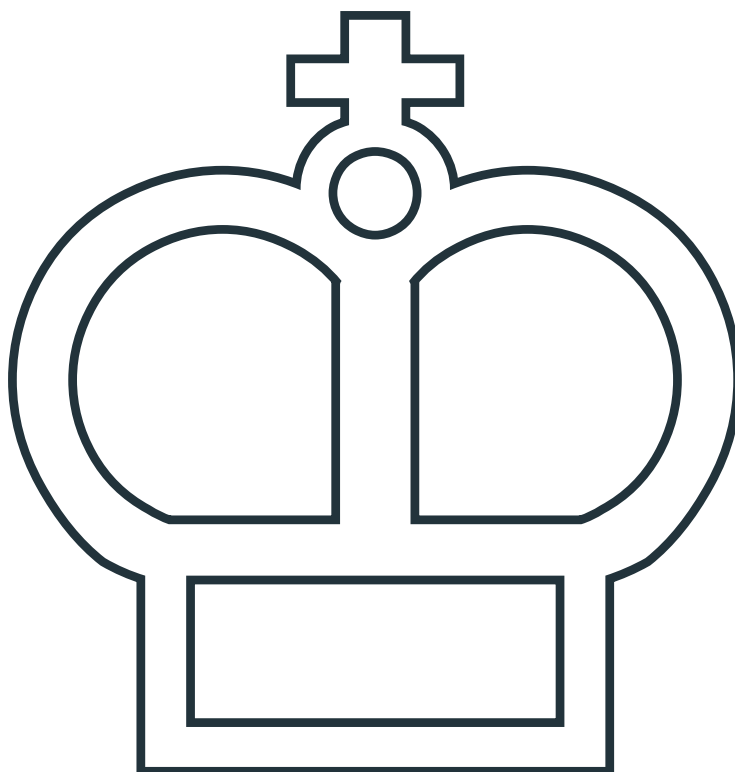
Moves: An L-shape: two squares in one direction, then one square sideways.



Pawn (1 point)

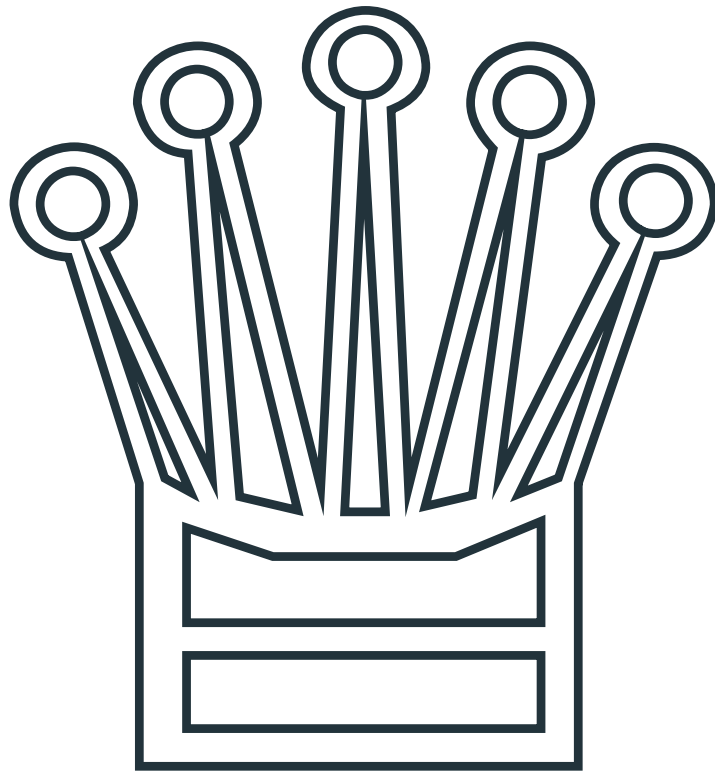
Moves: Forward one square (or two on its first move); captures diagonally.

Colour the King



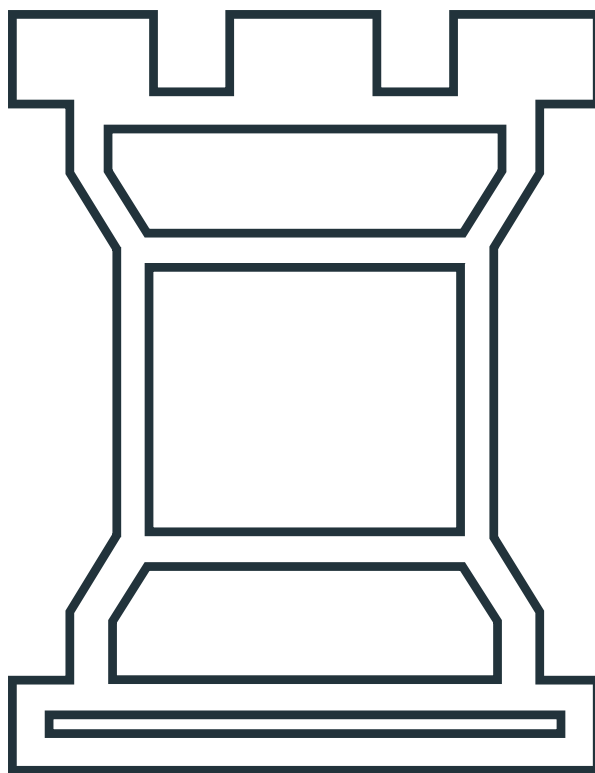
♔ **Chess Fact:** If the King has no safe square left and is under attack, the game ends in checkmate.

Colour the Queen



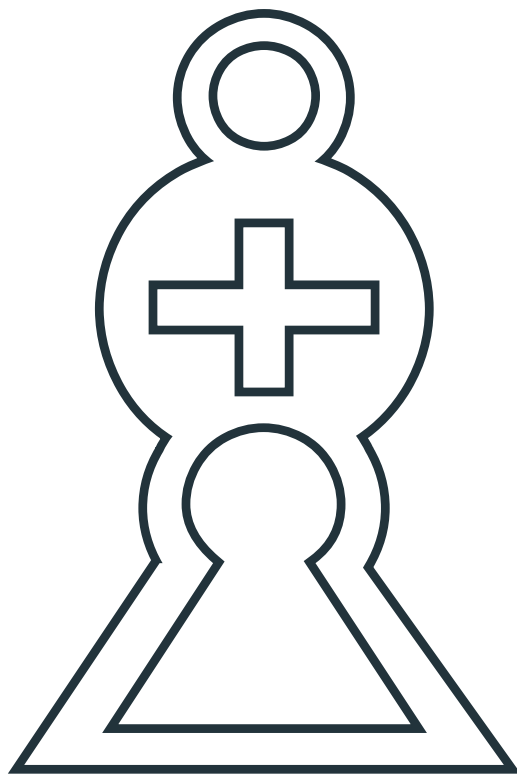
♛ **Chess Fact:** The Queen is the most powerful piece on the board — she combines the Rook and Bishop's moves!

Colour the Rook



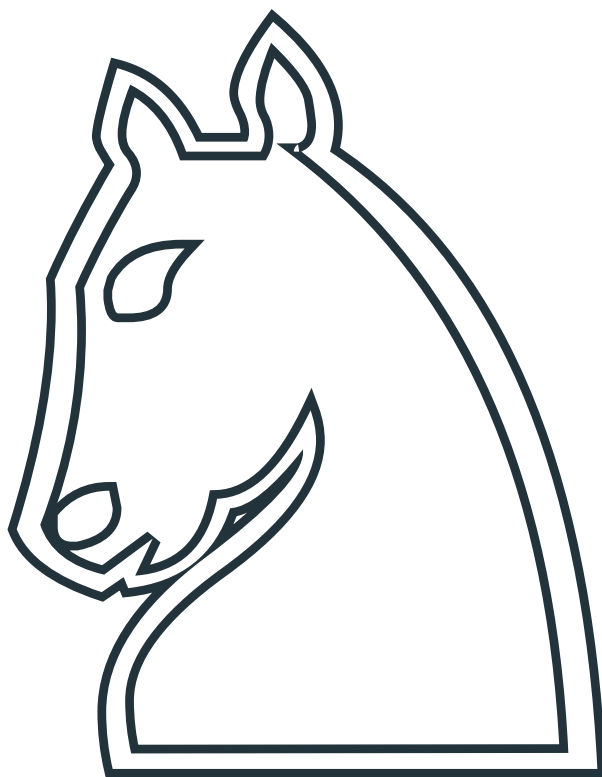
♖ Chess Fact: Two rooks working together can be incredibly powerful in the endgame.

Colour the Bishop



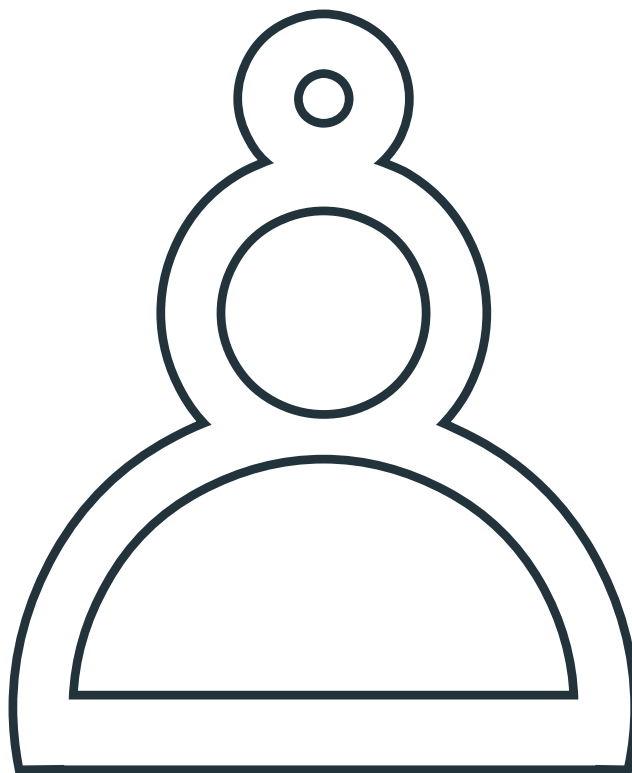
♠ Chess Fact: Each Bishop stays on one colour of square for the whole game — light or dark!

Colour the Knight



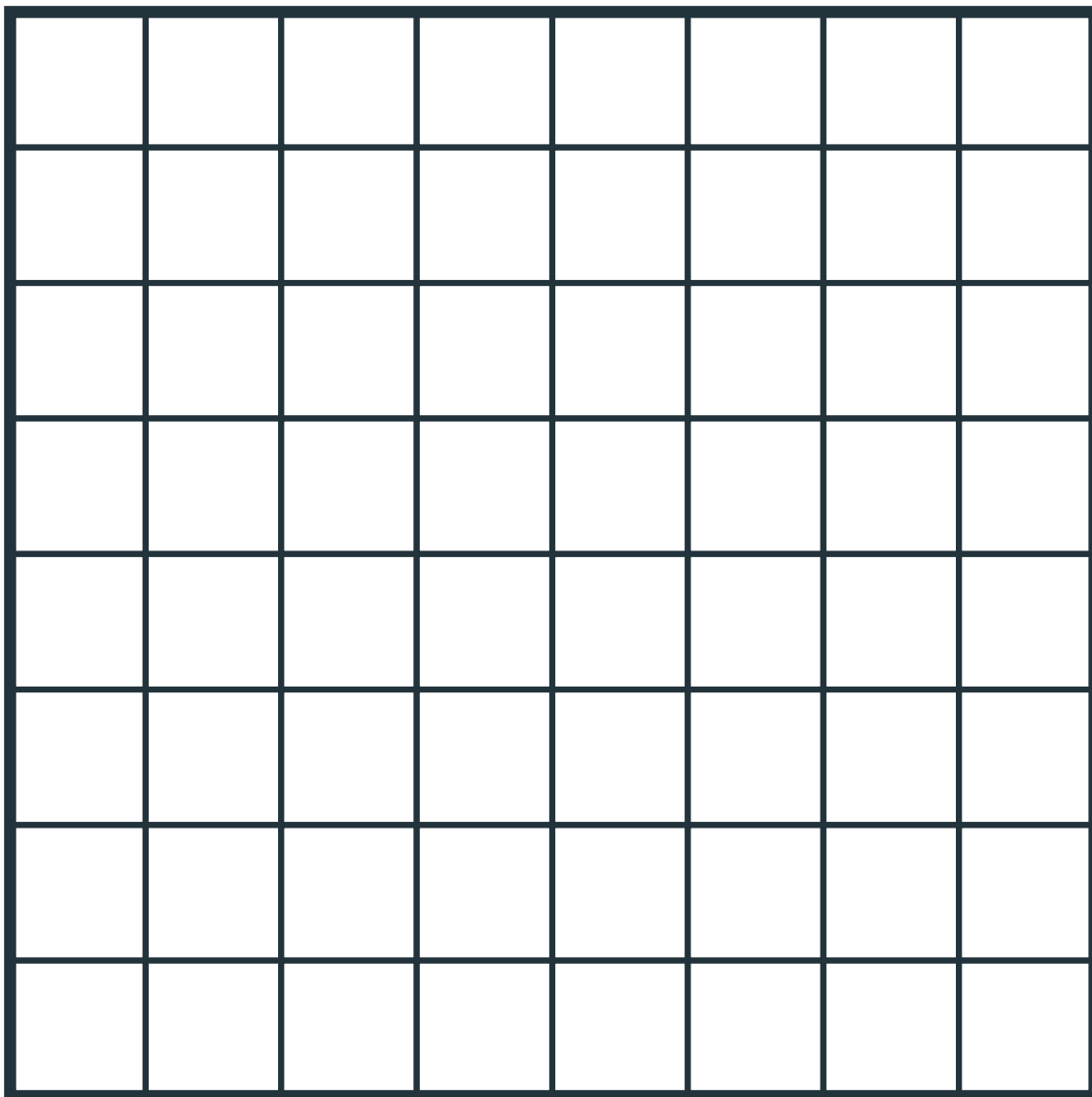
♠ Chess Fact: The Knight is the only piece that can jump over other pieces.

Colour the Pawn



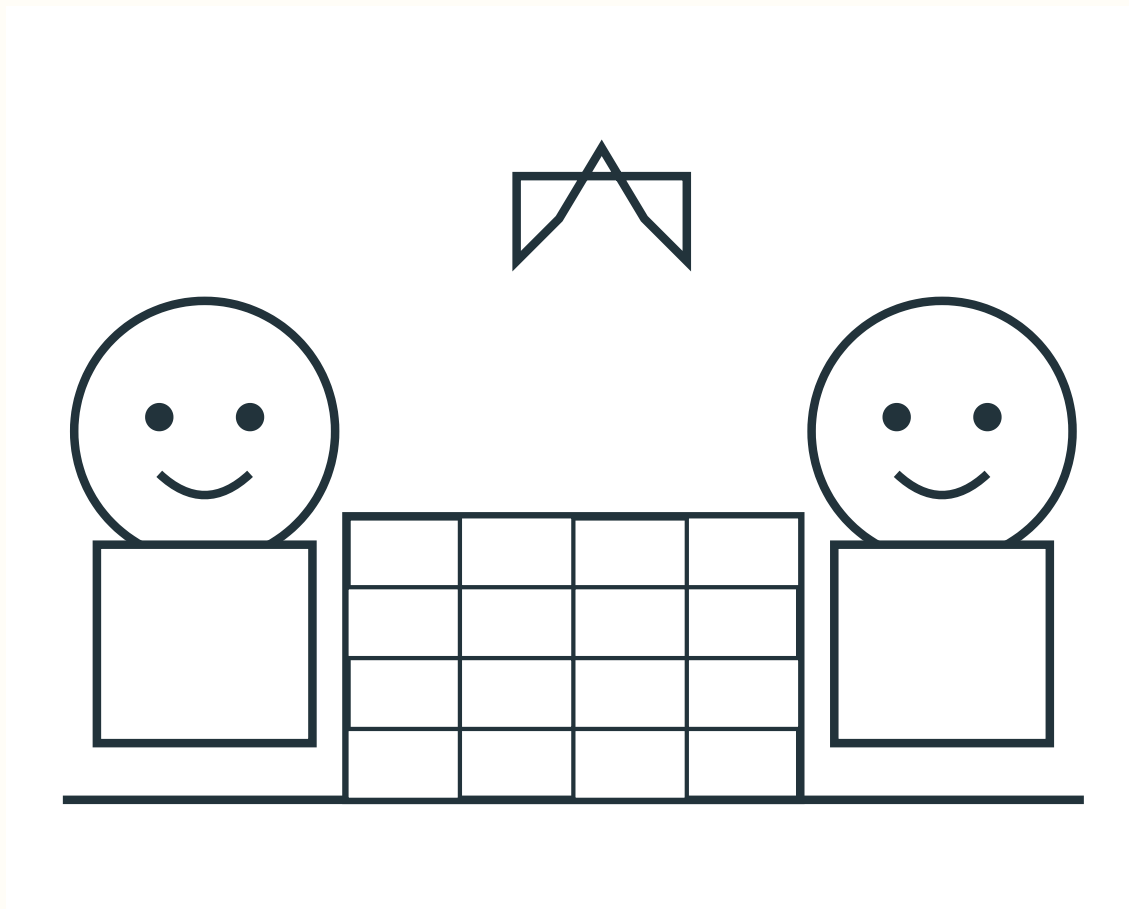
♟ Chess Fact: A pawn that reaches the far end of the board can be promoted into a Queen!

Colour the Chessboard



Colour every other square to make a checkerboard pattern, just like a real chessboard! Try two of your favourite colours.

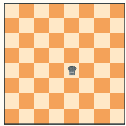
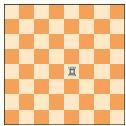
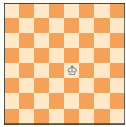
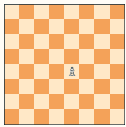
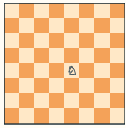
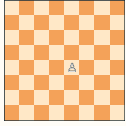
A Funny Chess Scene



Two friendly chess fans are playing on a giant chessboard! Colour the whole scene however you like.

Match the Piece to Its Name

Look at each chess piece on the left. Write the matching letter from the right-hand list in the box.



E. King

C. Queen

D. Rook

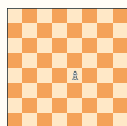
F. Bishop

B. Knight

A. Pawn

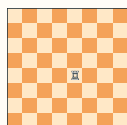
Match the Piece to Its Movement

Draw a line (or write the number) connecting each piece to the sentence that describes how it moves.



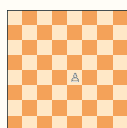
Any number of squares up, down, left or right (straight lines only).

Any number of squares in any direction: up, down, sideways or diagonally.



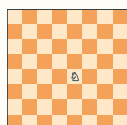
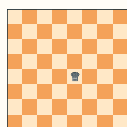
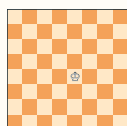
An L-shape: two squares in one direction, then one square sideways.

Forward one square (or two on its first move); captures diagonally.



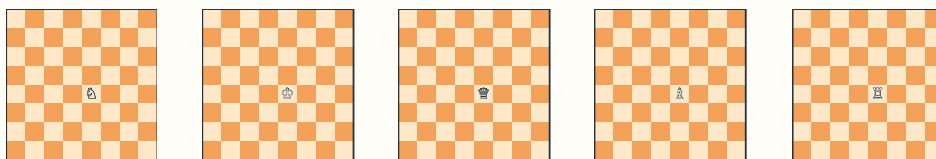
One square in any direction (except castling).

Any number of squares diagonally.



Which Piece Is Missing?

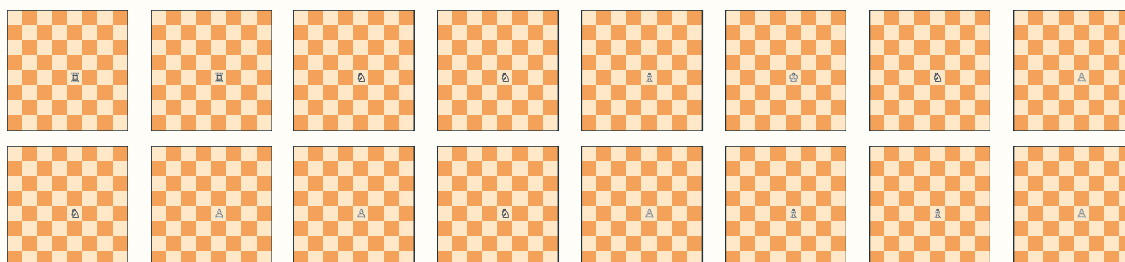
A full chess army has one King, one Queen, two Rooks, two Bishops and two Knights (plus pawns). One TYPE of piece below is completely missing from this row. Which one is it?



.....

Count the Chess Pieces

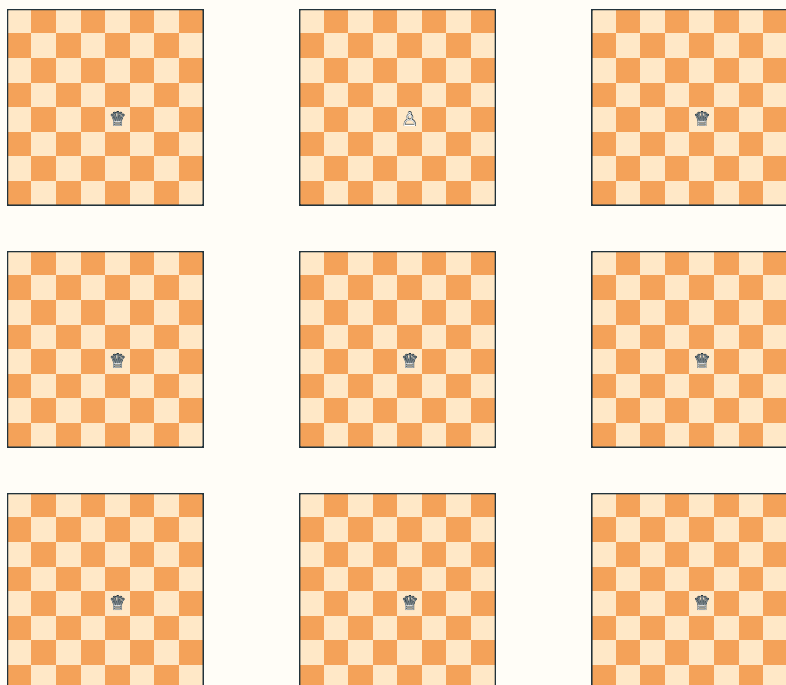
How many Knights can you count below? Write your answer in the box.



.....

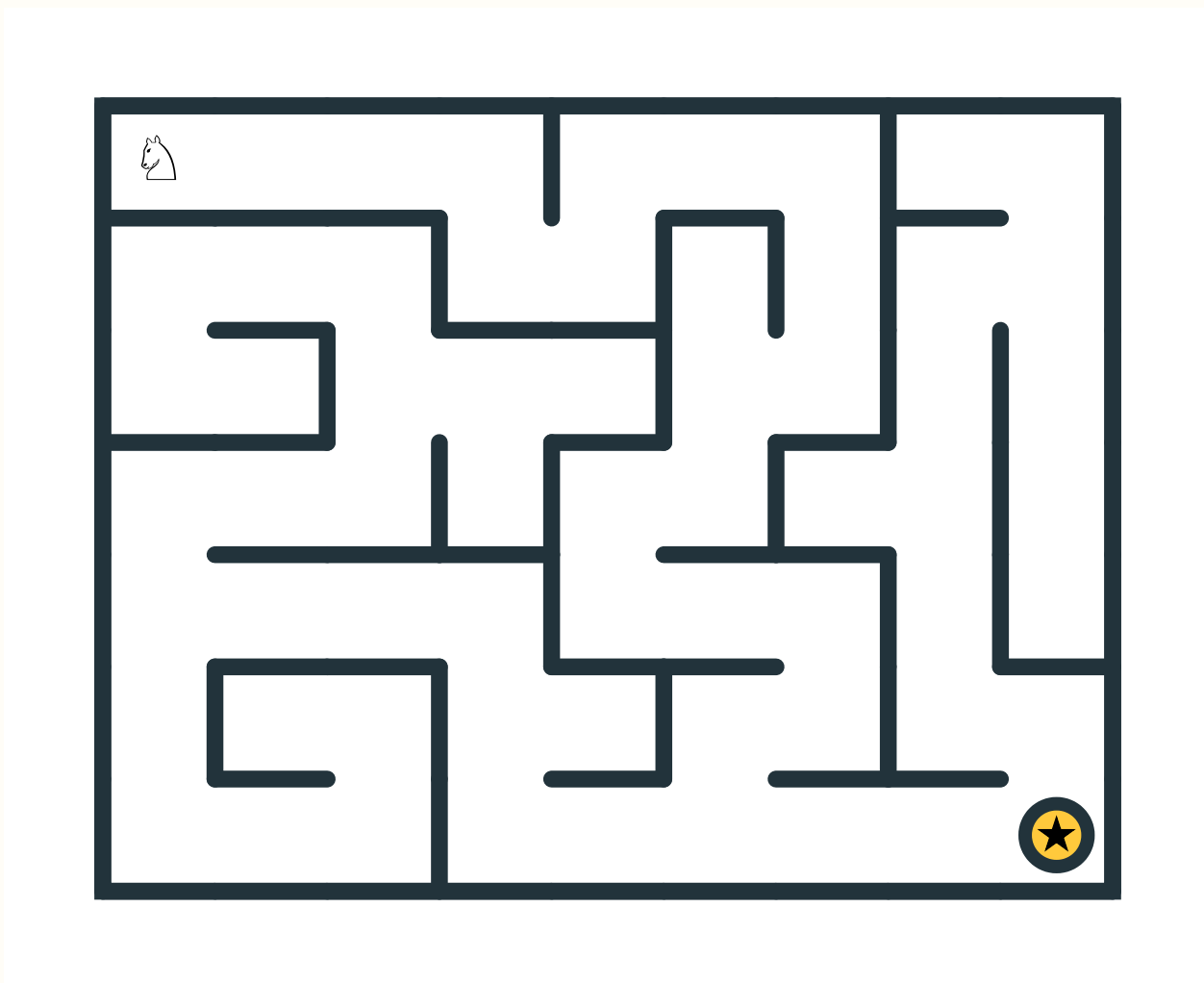
Find the Different Piece

Every piece below is the same type — except one! Circle the piece that does not belong.



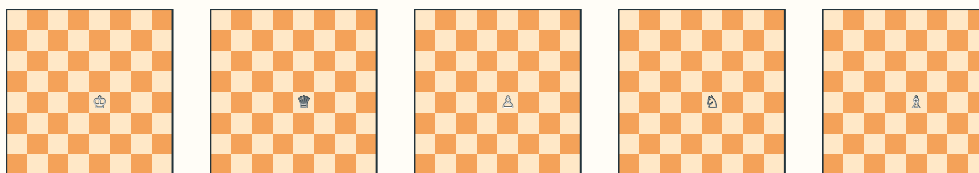
Help the Knight Find the Star

Trace a path from the Knight to the Star without crossing any walls.



Chess Piece Memory Challenge

Study this row of pieces carefully for ten seconds. Then ask a grown-up to cover the row, and try to write down the pieces in the correct order from memory!

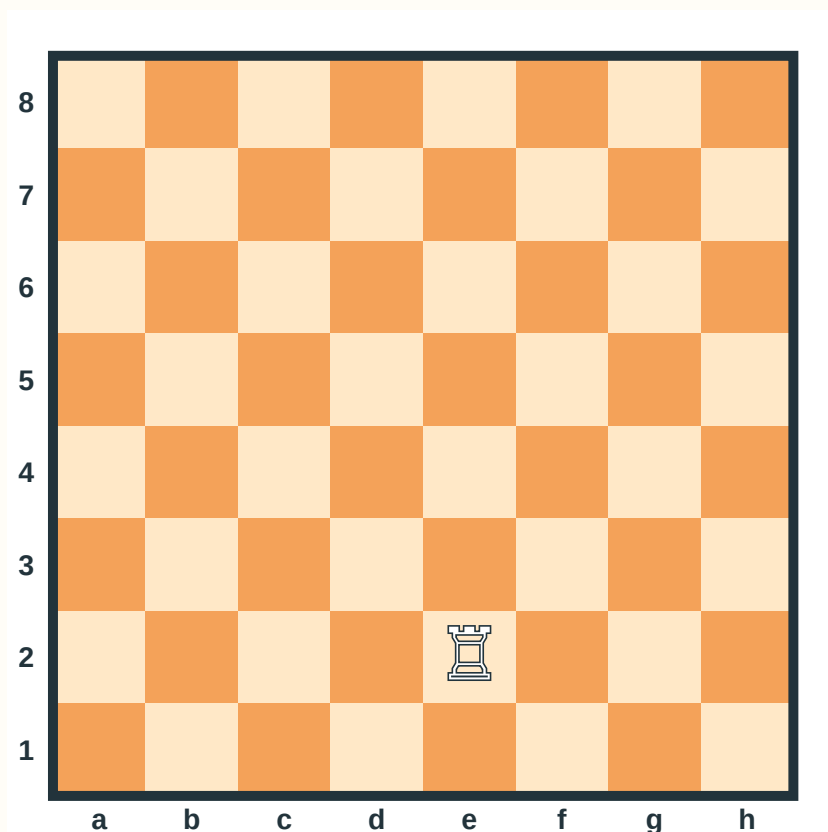


Now write the order from memory (1st to 5th):

.....

Which Square Can It Reach?

The Rook is on square e2. Which of the marked squares (A, B, C, D) could it move to in a single move? Circle all correct letters.



A = g2 B = e7 C = g1 D = a5

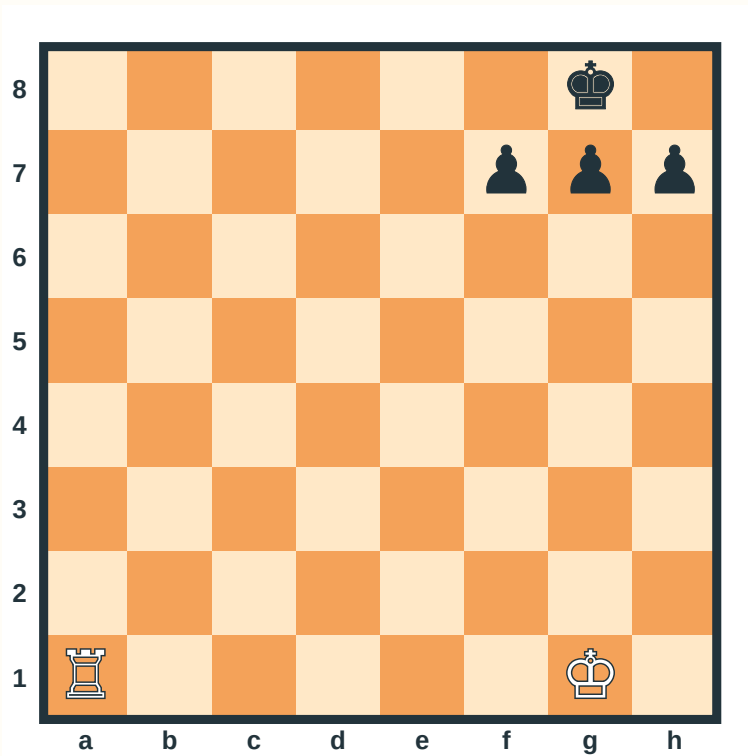
Piece Movement Recap Quiz

Fill in the blank with the correct piece name for each sentence.

1. The _____ moves any number of squares diagonally.
2. The _____ is the only piece that can jump over other pieces.
3. The _____ can move any number of squares in any straight or diagonal direction.
4. The _____ can only move one square at a time (except when castling).
5. The _____ moves forward but captures diagonally.
6. The _____ moves any number of squares up, down, left or right.

Find the Checkmate

Easy



White to move. Can you find the checkmate in one move?

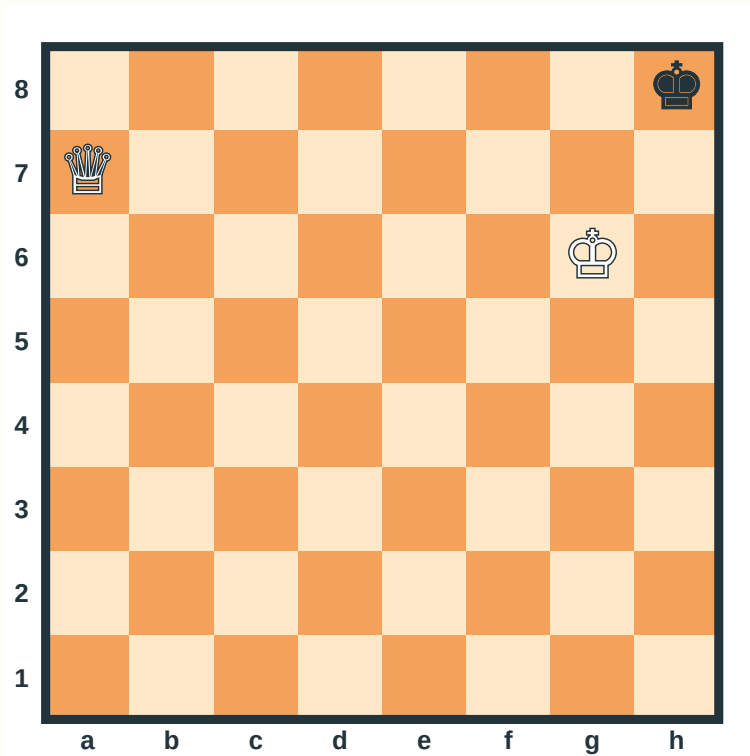
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Checkmate

Easy



White to move. Find the checkmate in one move.

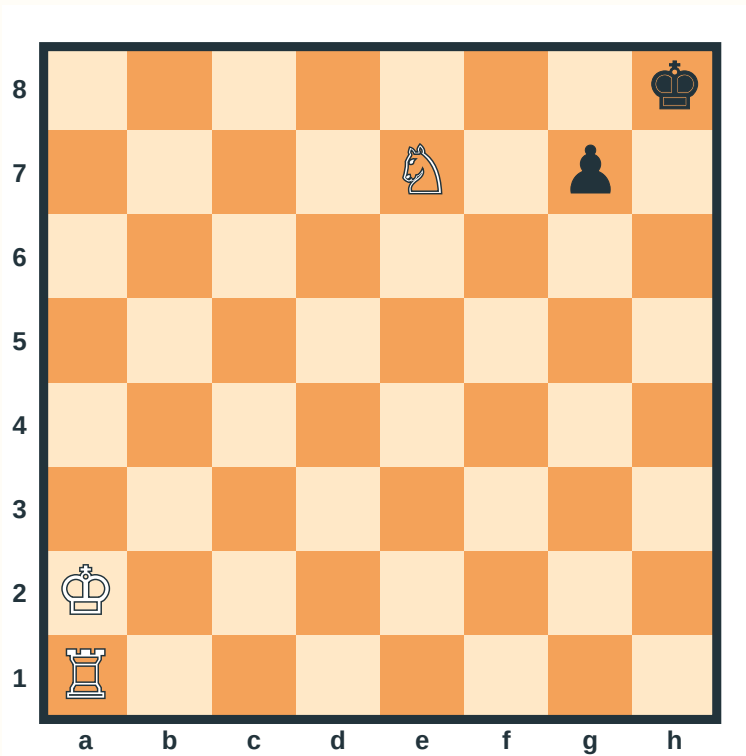
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Checkmate

Hard



White to move. This one is trickier — find the checkmate in one move.

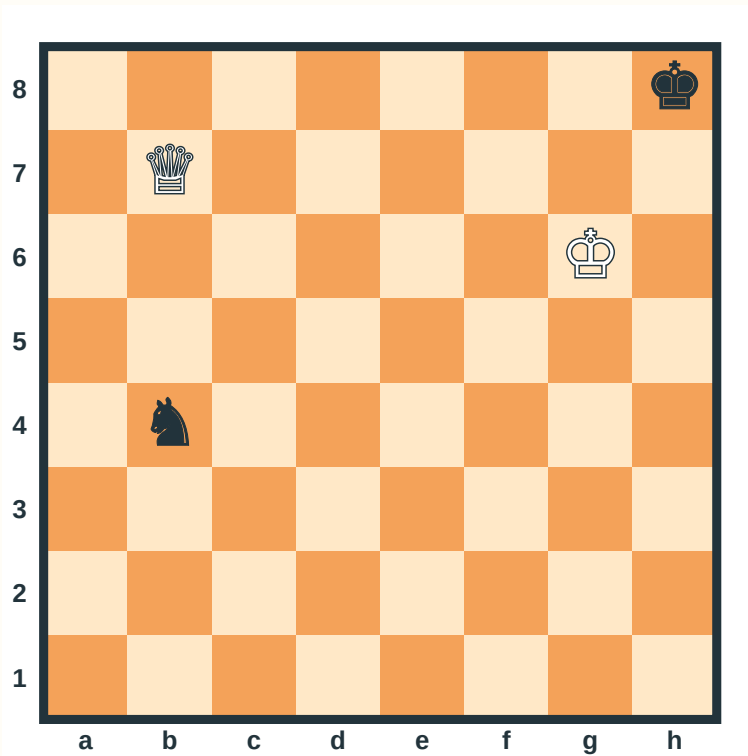
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Checkmate

Hard



Don't be distracted by the extra pieces on the board! White to move — find the checkmate in one move.

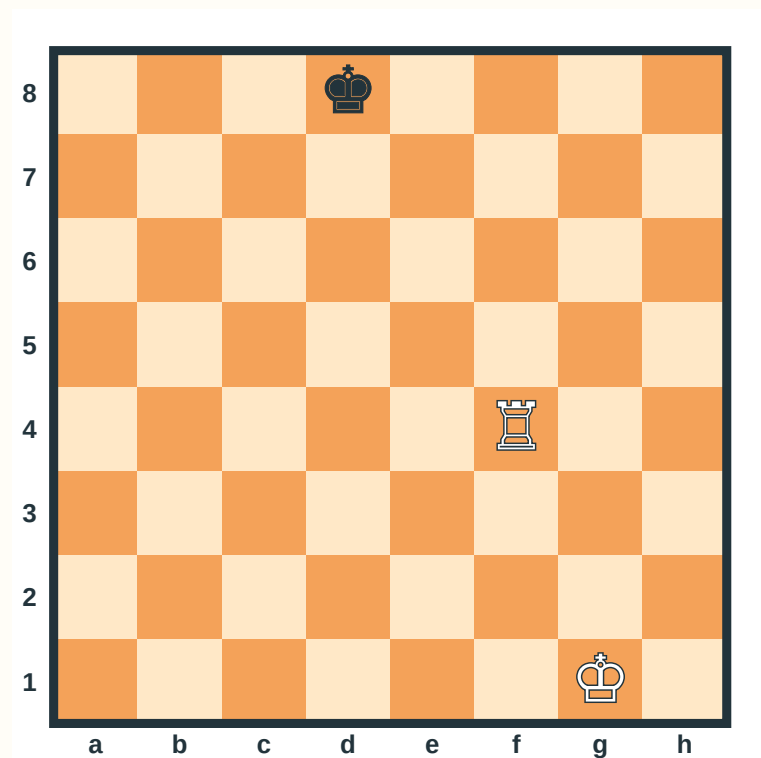
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Check

Easy



White to move. Which move gives check to the black king?

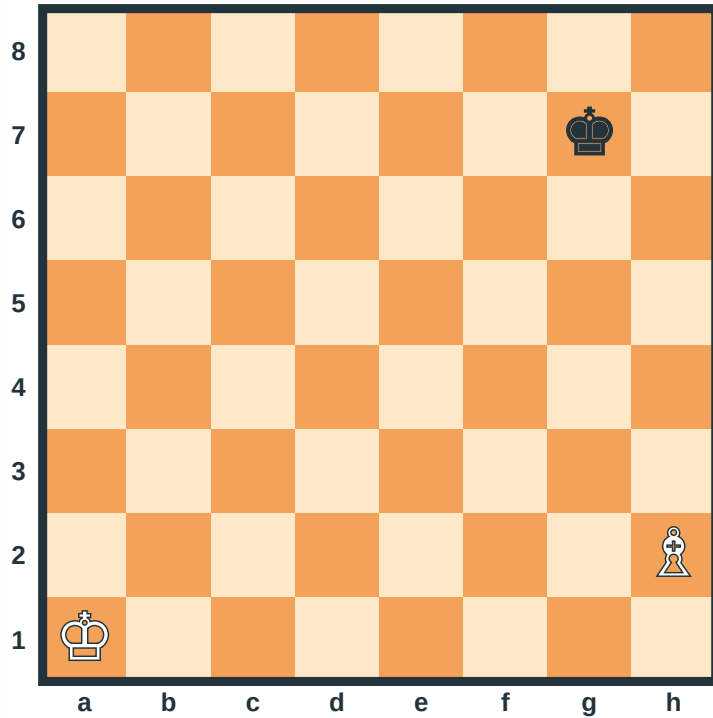
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Check

Medium



White to move. Find the move that puts the black king in check.

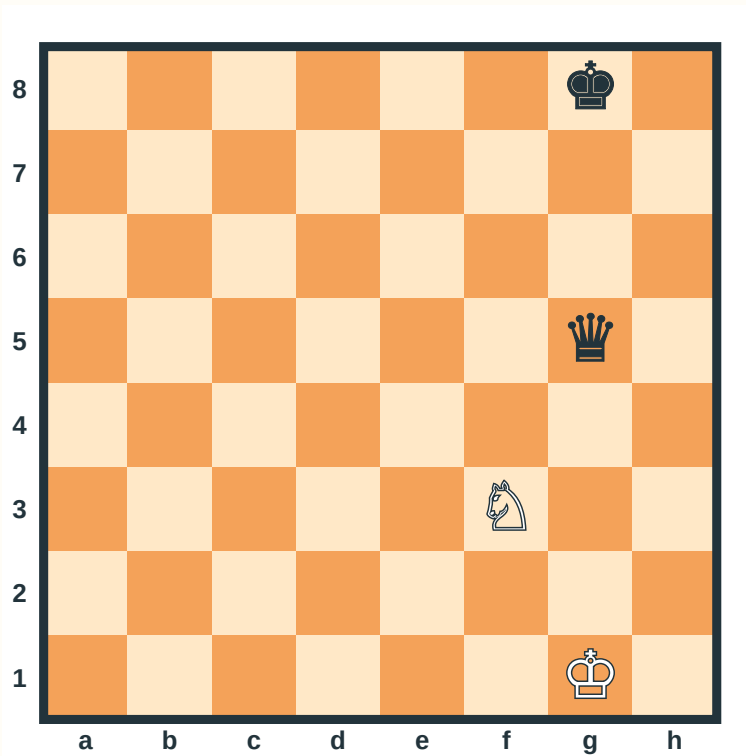
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Capture

Easy



White to move. Black left a piece hanging! Find the winning capture.

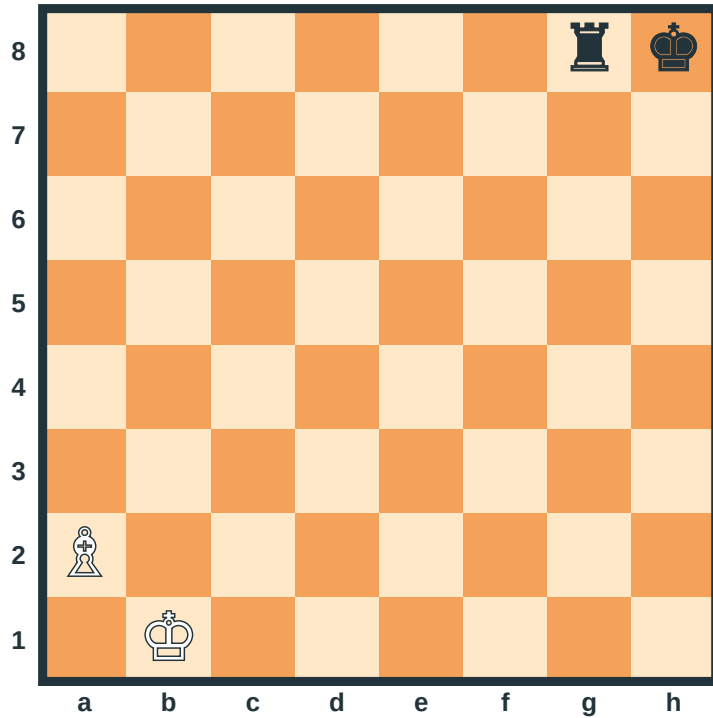
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Capture

Medium



White to move. Find the move that wins material by capturing.

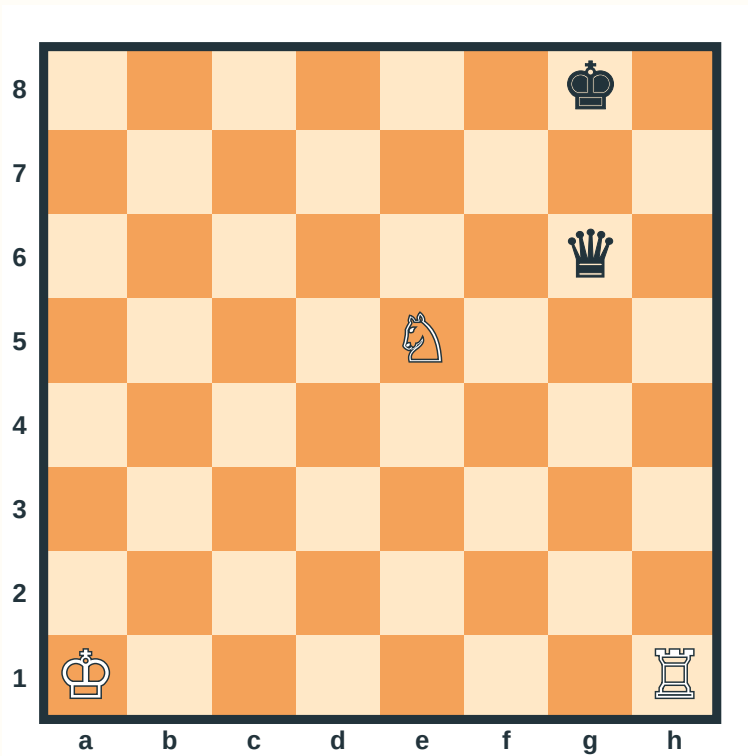
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Attacker

Easy



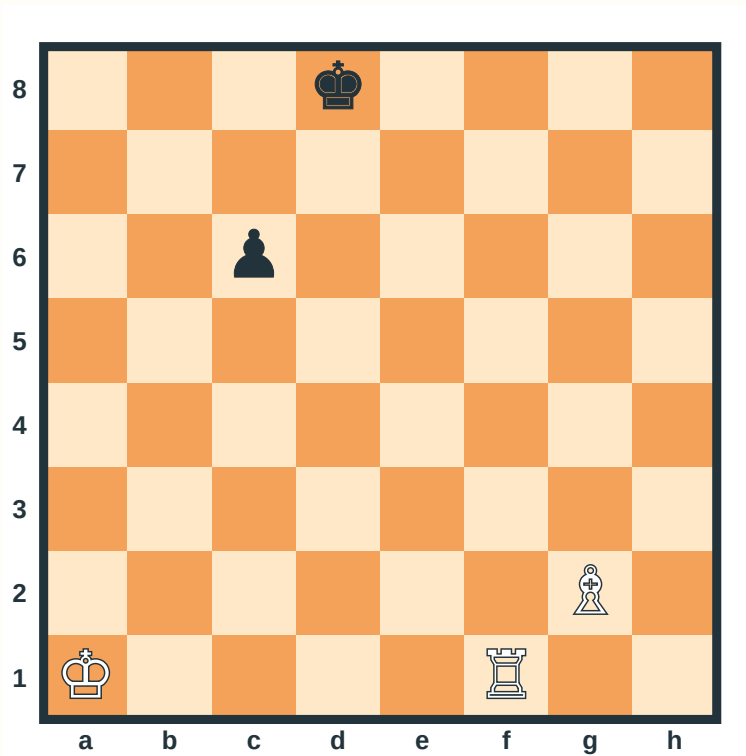
Look at the board. Which White piece is attacking the black queen on g6? (Knight or Rook?)

Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

Find the Attacker

Medium



Which White piece is attacking the pawn on c6 — the rook or the bishop?

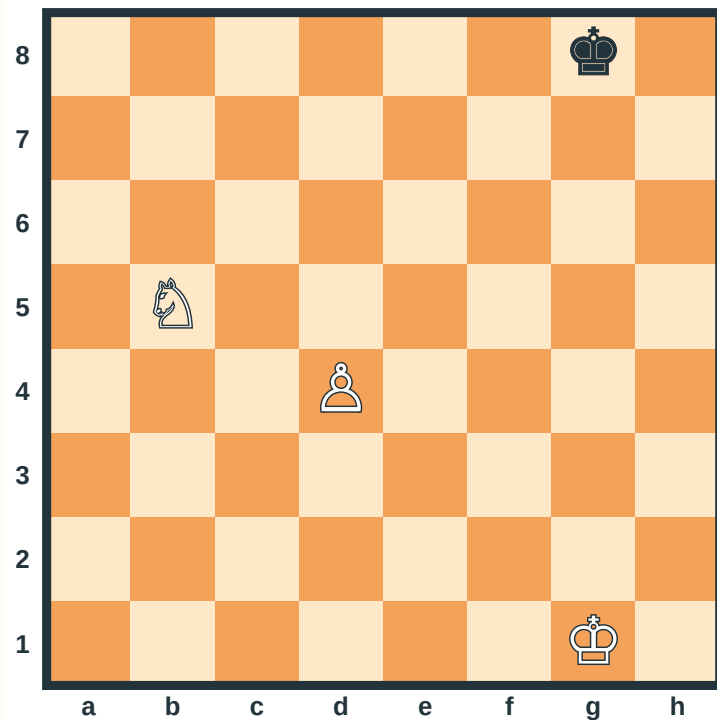
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Defender

Easy



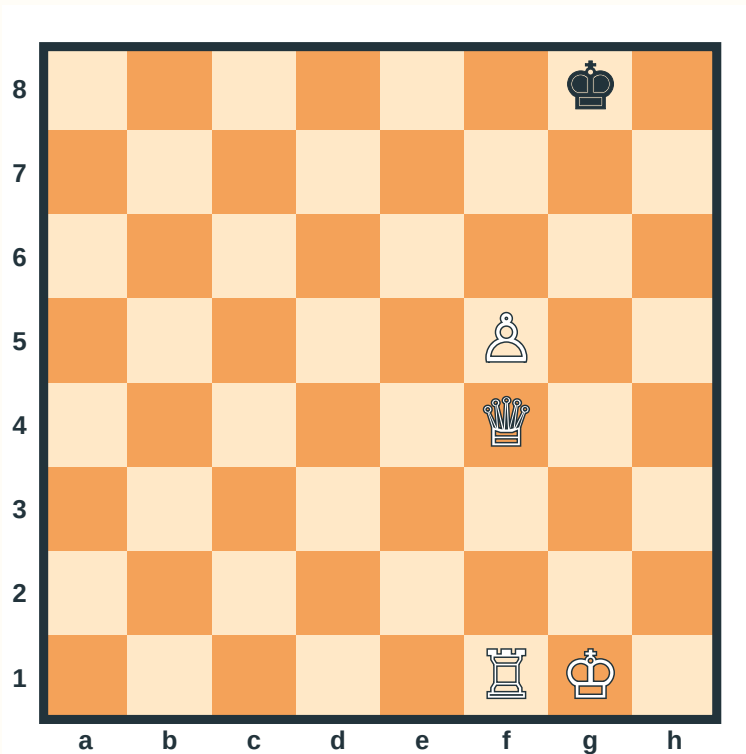
Black is about to attack the pawn on d4. Which White piece is already defending it?

Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

Find the Defender

Medium



Two White pieces are lined up on the f-file behind the pawn on f5. Which piece defends it directly, and which one is defending from further back?

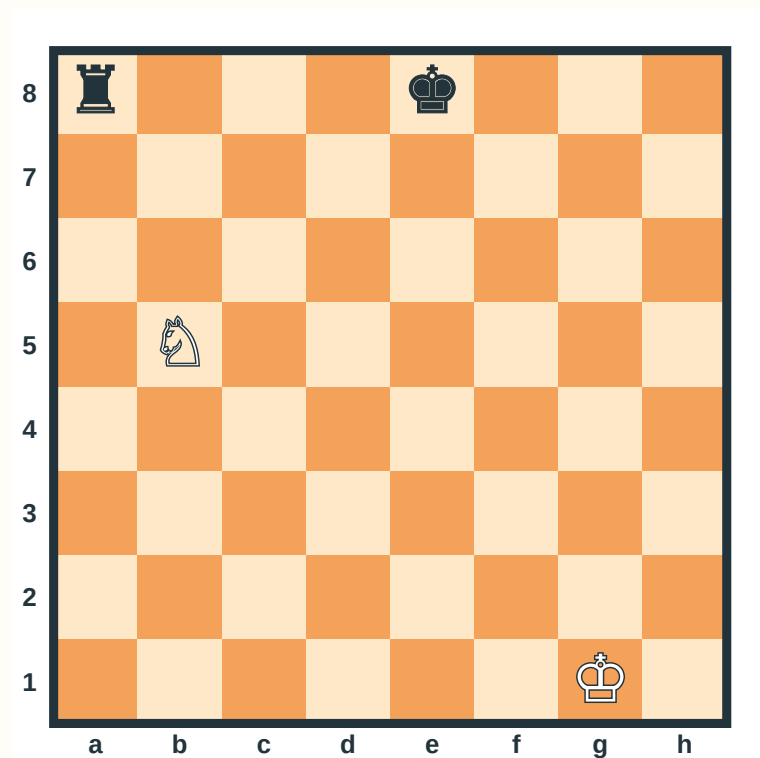
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Fork

Medium



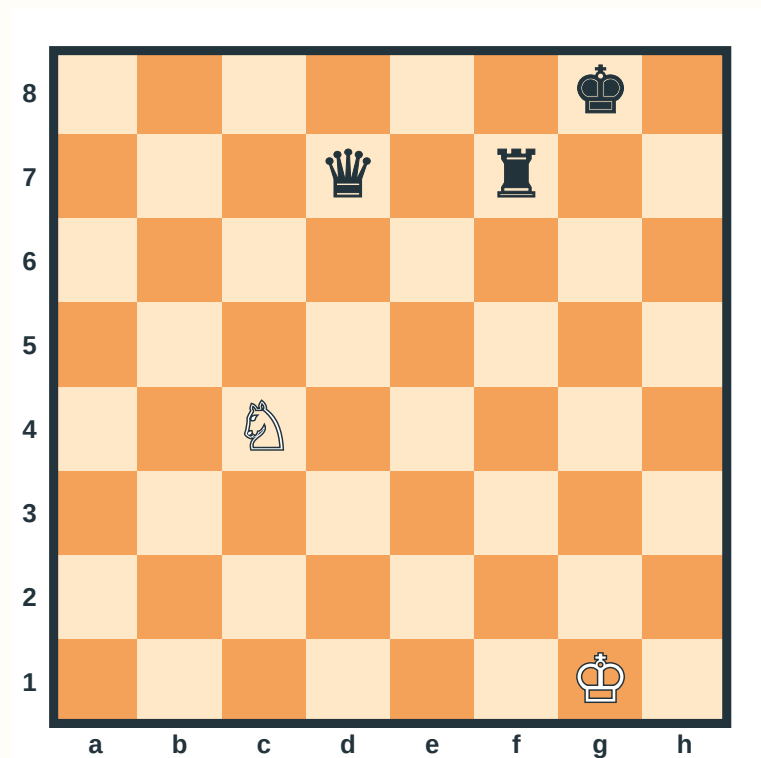
White to move. Find the knight move that attacks the king AND the rook at the same time!

Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

Find the Fork

Hard



White to move. One knight move attacks both the black queen and the black rook. Can you find it?

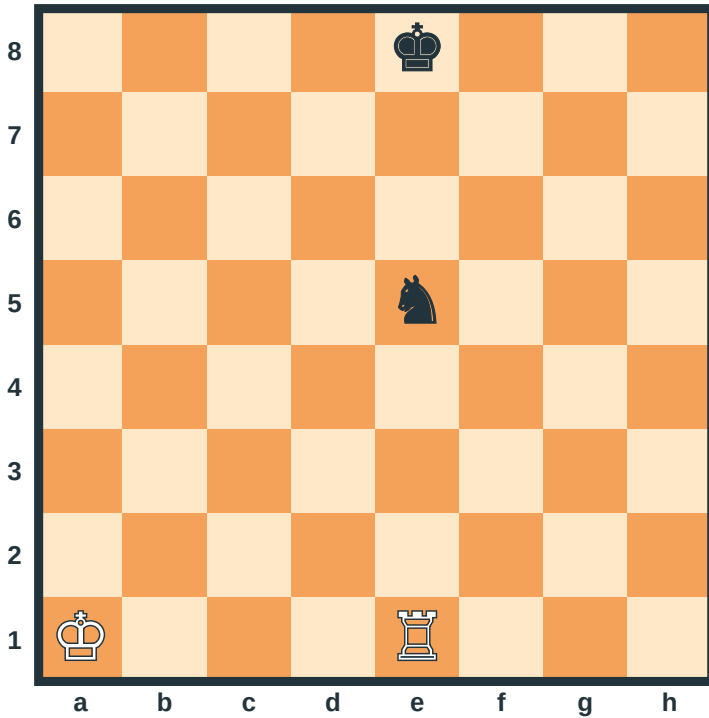
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Pin

Medium

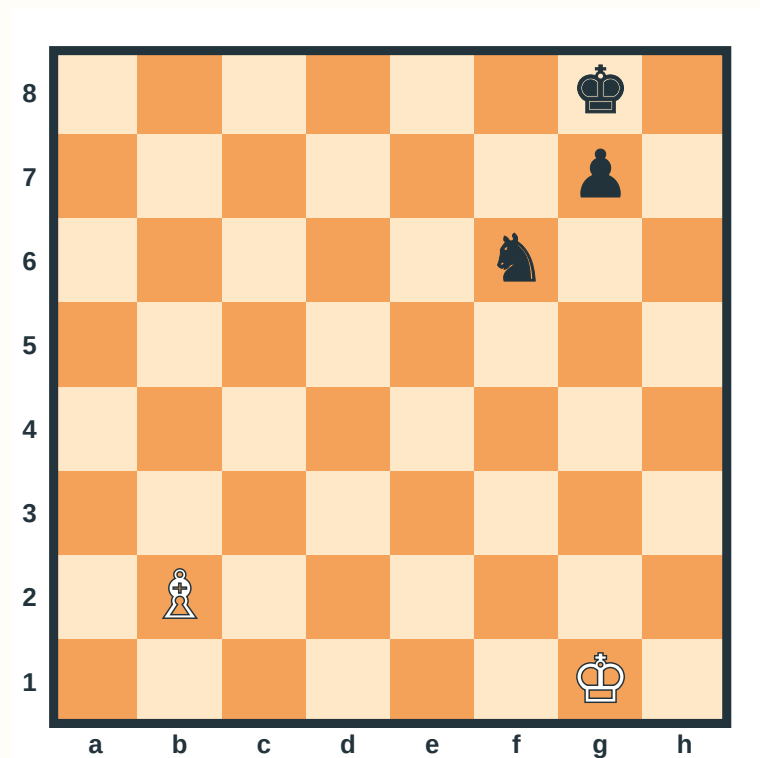


The black knight on e5 is pinned and cannot move — and nothing defends it! Find White's winning capture.

Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

Find the Pin

Hard

The knight on f6 is pinned to the king and nothing defends it! Find White's winning capture.

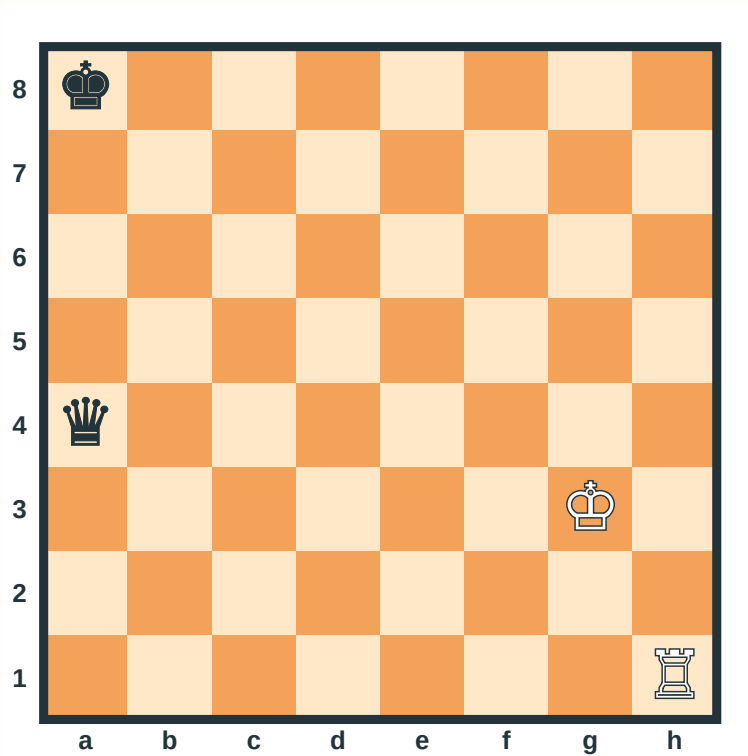
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Skewer

Medium



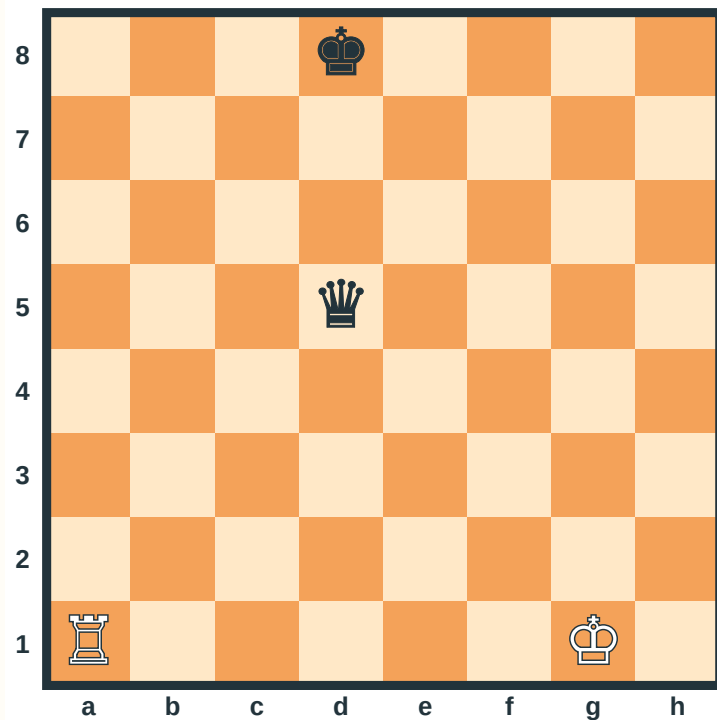
White to move. Find the rook move that skewers the black king and queen on the a-file.

Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Skewer

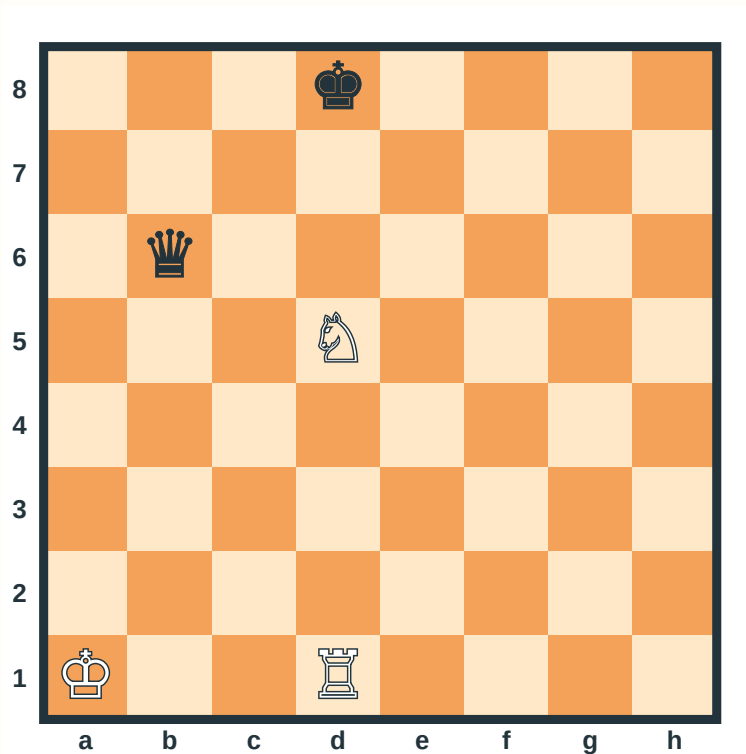
Hard

White to move. Find the rook move that skewers the black king and queen on the d-file.

Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

Find the Discovered Attack

Hard

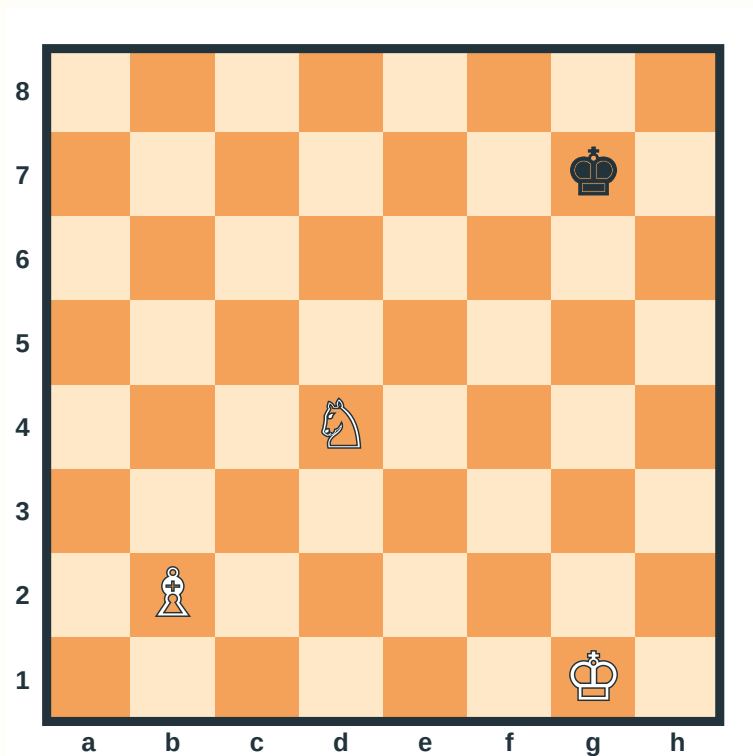
White to move. Moving the knight uncovers an attack from the rook behind it — and the knight can land on a great square too. Find the move.

Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

.....

Find the Discovered Attack

Hard

White to move. The bishop on b2 is aiming at the black king through the knight on d4. Which knight move uncovers a discovered check?

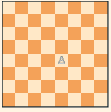
Side to move: White

Write your answer here:

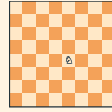
.....

Piece Values

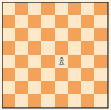
In chess, each piece has a point value that helps players judge trades. Learn these values — you will use them on every Chess Maths page!



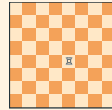
Pawn = 1 point



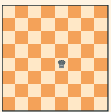
Knight = 3 points



Bishop = 3 points



Rook = 5 points



Queen = 9 points

👑 **Remember: the King is priceless and never given a point value — the whole game is about protecting your King!**

Chess Addition

1. Bishop (3) + Bishop (3) = ?

.....

2. Knight (3) + Queen (9) = ?

.....

3. Pawn (1) + Pawn (1) = ?

.....

4. Bishop (3) + Knight (3) = ?

.....

5. Bishop (3) + Queen (9) = ?

.....

6. Queen (9) + Queen (9) = ?

.....

Chess Addition (More Practice)

1. Pawn (1) + Queen (9) = ?

.....

2. Knight (3) + Bishop (3) = ?

.....

3. Knight (3) + Knight (3) = ?

.....

4. Bishop (3) + Knight (3) = ?

.....

5. Knight (3) + Pawn (1) = ?

.....

6. Pawn (1) + Rook (5) = ?

.....

Chess Subtraction

1. Rook (5) – Knight (3) = ?

.....

2. Knight (3) – Pawn (1) = ?

.....

3. Queen (9) – Rook (5) = ?

.....

4. Queen (9) – Rook (5) = ?

.....

5. Queen (9) – Rook (5) = ?

.....

6. Queen (9) – Queen (9) = ?

.....

Chess Subtraction (More Practice)

1. Bishop (3) – Bishop (3) = ?

.....

2. Knight (3) – Knight (3) = ?

.....

3. Rook (5) – Knight (3) = ?

.....

4. Queen (9) – Knight (3) = ?

.....

5. Bishop (3) – Pawn (1) = ?

.....

6. Bishop (3) – Bishop (3) = ?

.....

Chess Multiplication

1. 4 Knights $\times$ 3 points each = ?

.....

2. 3 Bishops $\times$ 3 points each = ?

.....

3. 3 Bishops $\times$ 3 points each = ?

.....

4. 4 Rooks $\times$ 5 points each = ?

.....

5. 3 Knights $\times$ 3 points each = ?

.....

6. 3 Queens $\times$ 9 points each = ?

.....

Chess Multiplication (More Practice)

1. 4 Rooks $\times$ 5 points each = ?

.....

2. 2 Queens $\times$ 9 points each = ?

.....

3. 4 Rooks $\times$ 5 points each = ?

.....

4. 4 Knights $\times$ 3 points each = ?

.....

5. 4 Bishops $\times$ 3 points each = ?

.....

6. 2 Knights $\times$ 3 points each = ?

.....

Chess Counting

1. A chessboard has 8 rows and 8 columns of squares. How many squares are there in total?

.....

2. A chessboard has 8 rows and 8 columns of squares. How many squares are there in total?

.....

3. A chessboard has 8 rows and 8 columns of squares. How many squares are there in total?

.....

4. A chessboard has 8 rows and 8 columns of squares. How many squares are there in total?

.....

5. A chessboard has 8 rows and 8 columns of squares. How many squares are there in total?

.....

Chess Counting (More Practice)

1. If White has captured 5 black pawns during a game, how many points has White won?

.....

2. If White has captured 9 black pawns during a game, how many points has White won?

.....

3. If White has captured 8 black pawns during a game, how many points has White won?

.....

4. If White has captured 10 black pawns during a game, how many points has White won?

.....

5. If White has captured 11 black pawns during a game, how many points has White won?

.....

Chess Word Problems

1. Zara captures a Rook (5 points) and a Bishop (3 points) in one game. How many points did Zara win in total?

.....

2. Anaya starts a tournament with 0 points and wins 3 games, earning 1 point per win. How many tournament points does Anaya have now?

.....

3. Priya has a Queen (9 points) and trades it for the opponent's Rook (5 points) and Knight (3 points). Did Priya gain or lose points, and by how much?

.....

4. A chess tournament has 5 rounds. If Kabir wins every round, and a win is worth 1 point, how many points will Kabir finish with?

.....

5. Dev had 12 points worth of pieces and lost a Knight (3 points) and a Pawn (1 point). How many points worth of pieces does Dev have left?

.....

Chess Word Problems (More Practice)

1. Rohan captures a Rook (5 points) and a Bishop (3 points) in one game. How many points did Rohan win in total?

.....

2. Zara starts a tournament with 0 points and wins 5 games, earning 1 point per win. How many tournament points does Zara have now?

.....

3. Dev has a Queen (9 points) and trades it for the opponent's Rook (5 points) and Knight (3 points). Did Dev gain or lose points, and by how much?

.....

4. A chess tournament has 3 rounds. If Priya wins every round, and a win is worth 1 point, how many points will Priya finish with?

.....

5. Arjun had 12 points worth of pieces and lost a Knight (3 points) and a Pawn (1 point). How many points worth of pieces does Arjun have left?

.....

Chess Word Problems (Challenge)

1. Kabir captures a Rook (5 points) and a Bishop (3 points) in one game. How many points did Kabir win in total?

.....

2. Arjun starts a tournament with 0 points and wins 4 games, earning 1 point per win. How many tournament points does Arjun have now?

.....

3. Mia has a Queen (9 points) and trades it for the opponent's Rook (5 points) and Knight (3 points). Did Mia gain or lose points, and by how much?

.....

4. A chess tournament has 6 rounds. If Rohan wins every round, and a win is worth 1 point, how many points will Rohan finish with?

.....

5. Dev had 12 points worth of pieces and lost a Knight (3 points) and a Pawn (1 point). How many points worth of pieces does Dev have left?

.....

Chessboard Coordinates

1. Which square is on file "d" and rank "8"? Write its name.

.....

2. Look at the square d5. Which file is it on?

.....

3. Look at the square f1. Which rank is it on?

.....

4. Which square is on file "h" and rank "1"? Write its name.

.....

5. Look at the square a3. Which file is it on?

.....

6. Look at the square b4. Which rank is it on?

.....

Chessboard Coordinates (More Practice)

1. Which square is on file "c" and rank "6"? Write its name.

.....

2. Look at the square d6. Which file is it on?

.....

3. Look at the square a3. Which rank is it on?

.....

4. Which square is on file "b" and rank "7"? Write its name.

.....

5. Look at the square d2. Which file is it on?

.....

6. Look at the square b7. Which rank is it on?

.....

Chessboard Coordinates (Challenge)

1. Which square is on file "c" and rank "5"? Write its name.

.....

2. Look at the square h8. Which file is it on?

.....

3. Look at the square a1. Which rank is it on?

.....

4. Which square is on file "c" and rank "1"? Write its name.

.....

5. Look at the square c4. Which file is it on?

.....

6. Look at the square g4. Which rank is it on?

.....

Pattern Recognition

Look at the pattern of shapes below. What shape comes next? Draw it in the empty box.



Odd One Out

Four of these shapes are the same, but one is different. Circle the odd one out!



Shape Matching

Draw a line to match each shape on the left with the SAME shape on the right.



Number Sequences

Look at the number pattern. What number comes next?

4 6 8 10 →

Hint: look at how much the numbers increase by each time.

Simple Logic Puzzles

Read each statement carefully, then answer the question using logical thinking.

1. Every piece on a chessboard is either White or Black. This piece is not White. What colour must it be?

.....

2. If today is chess club day, Zara brings her chessboard. Zara brought her chessboard today. Is today chess club day (assuming she only brings it on chess club day)?

.....

3. All Knights can jump. Sir Knightley is a Knight. Can Sir Knightley jump?

.....

Shape Memory Challenge

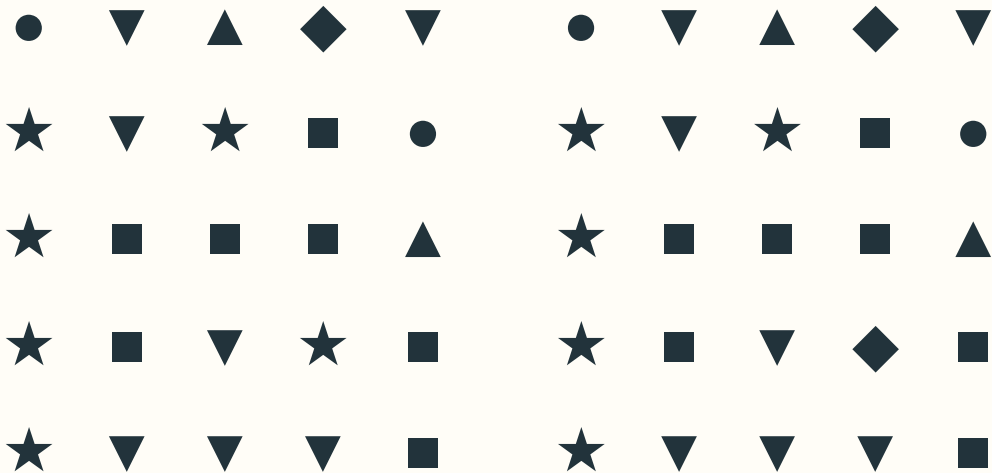
Study this row of shapes for ten seconds. Cover it up, then write the shapes in order from memory using their names (circle, square, triangle, diamond, star).



.....

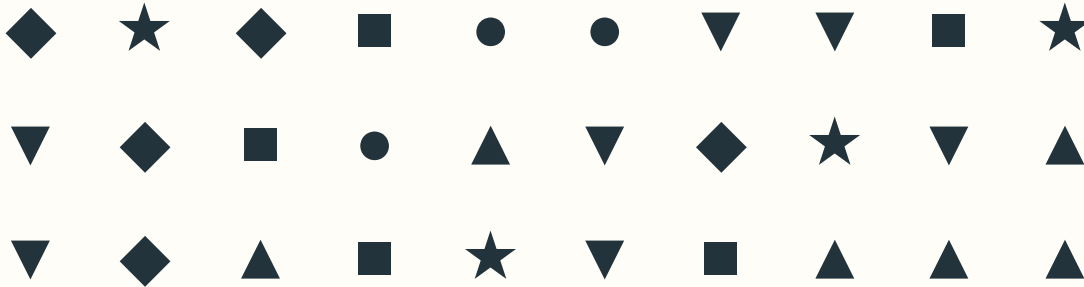
Spot the Difference

These two grids look the same, but ONE shape is different between them. Can you spot it and circle it in the second grid?



Counting Challenge

Count how many triangle (down)s you can find below.

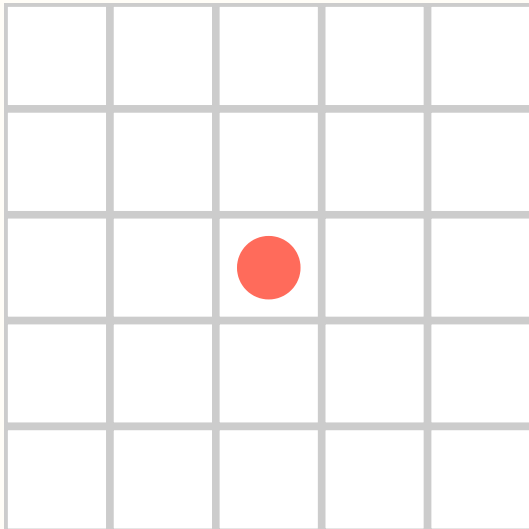


.....

Direction Challenge

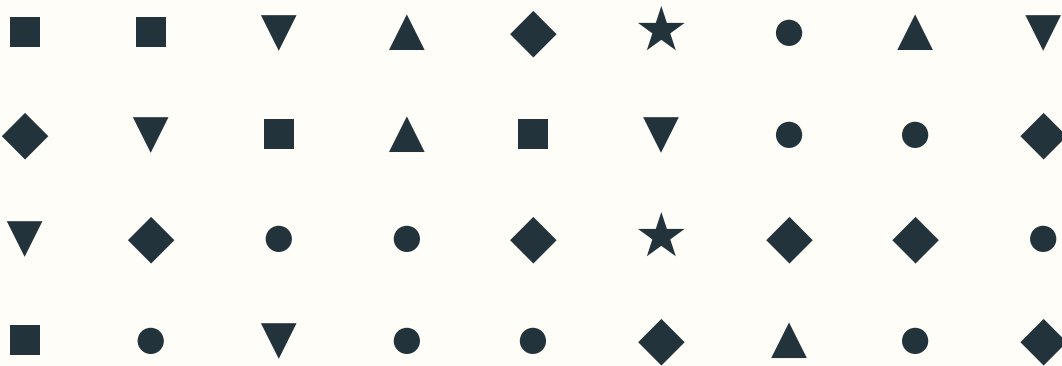
A chess piece starts on the square marked with a dot. Follow the directions below, one step at a time, and mark where it ends up on the grid.

1. West ←
2. South ↓
3. West ←



Visual Observation

Look carefully at the grid below. Without counting out loud, try to spot roughly how many triangle (down)s are hiding in it — then count carefully to check your guess!



My guess: _____

My count: _____

Strategy Challenge

Think like a chess player! Read each scenario and decide on the smartest strategy.

1. You can trade your Rook (5 points) for either the opponent's Knight (3 points) or their Queen (9 points). Which trade is better for you?
2. You have three coins: one worth 1 point, one worth 5 points and one worth 9 points. You may only pick ONE. Which should you pick to have the most points, and why?

Write your reasoning below:

Write your reasoning below:

What Comes Next?

This shape pattern repeats. What are the next TWO shapes in the sequence? Draw them in the empty boxes.



Simple Reasoning Puzzles

Use careful reasoning to answer each question below.

1. A chess match lasted longer than a checkers match. The checkers match lasted longer than a game of tic-tac-toe. Which game was the SHORTEST?

.....

2. Three friends are playing chess. Only two people can play at once, and one person must wait. If Arjun and Priya are playing right now, who is waiting?

.....

3. If every Bishop stays on one colour for the whole game, and this Bishop started on a light square, what colour square must it always be on?

.....

Odd One Out

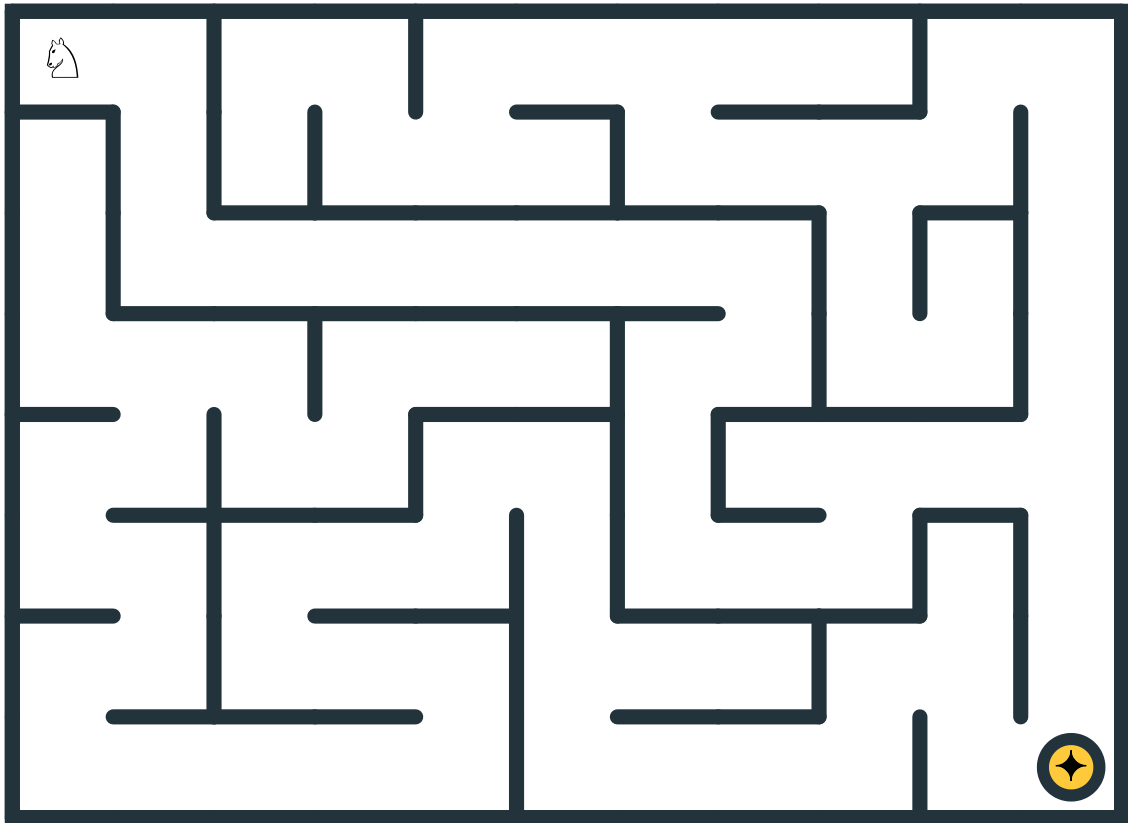
Four of these shapes are the same, but one is different. Circle the odd one out!



CHESS MAZE

Help the Knight Reach the Treasure

Trace a path from the start to the goal without crossing any maze walls. There is only one correct path — take your time!



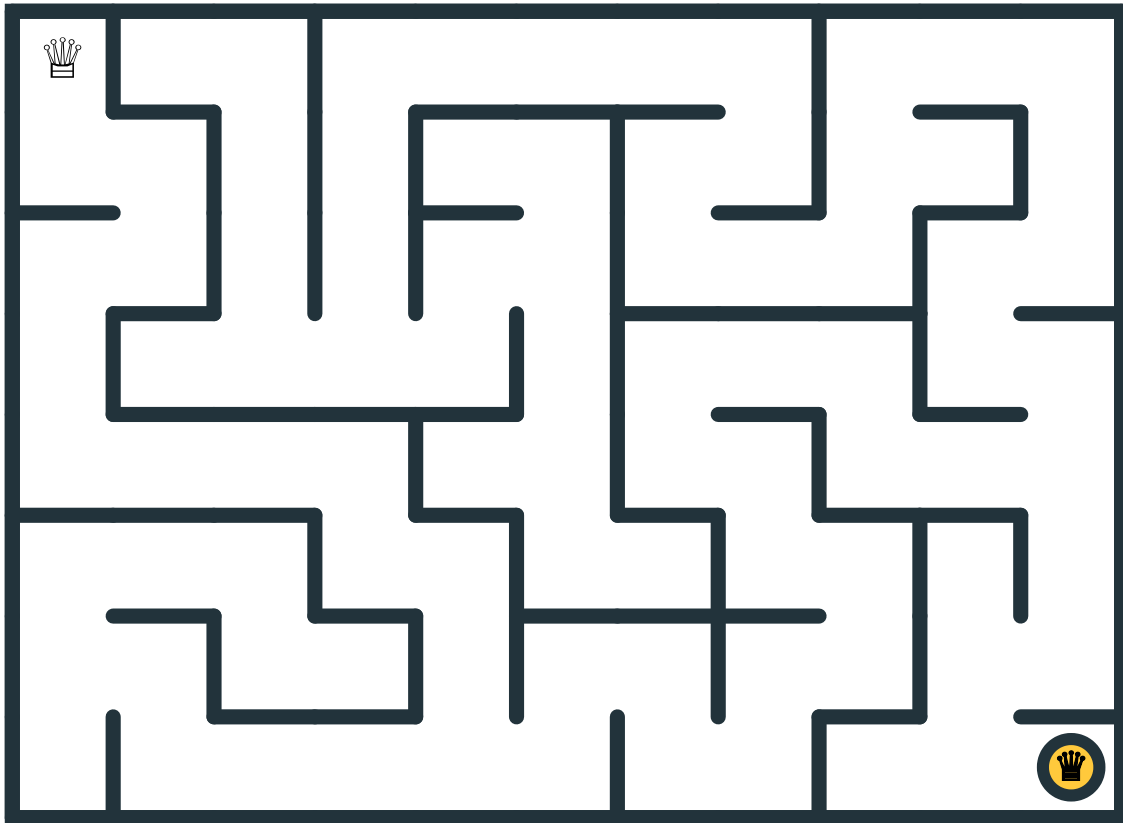
Help the King Reach the Castle

A square maze with a white king chess piece at the top-left and a yellow rook chess piece at the bottom-right. The maze is composed of black lines forming a complex path.

CHESS MAZE

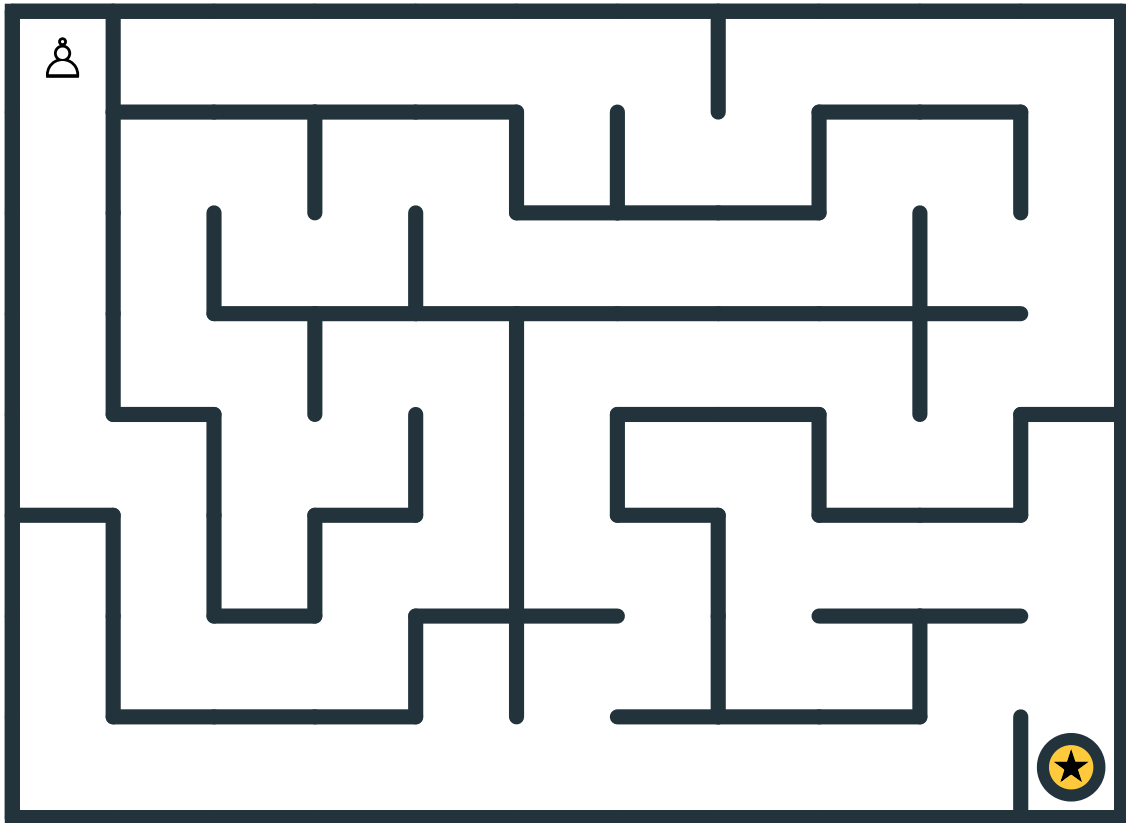
Help the Queen Reach the Crown

Trace a path from the start to the goal without crossing any maze walls. There is only one correct path — take your time!



Find the Safest Route for the Pawn

Trace a path from the start to the goal without crossing any maze walls. There is only one correct path — take your time!

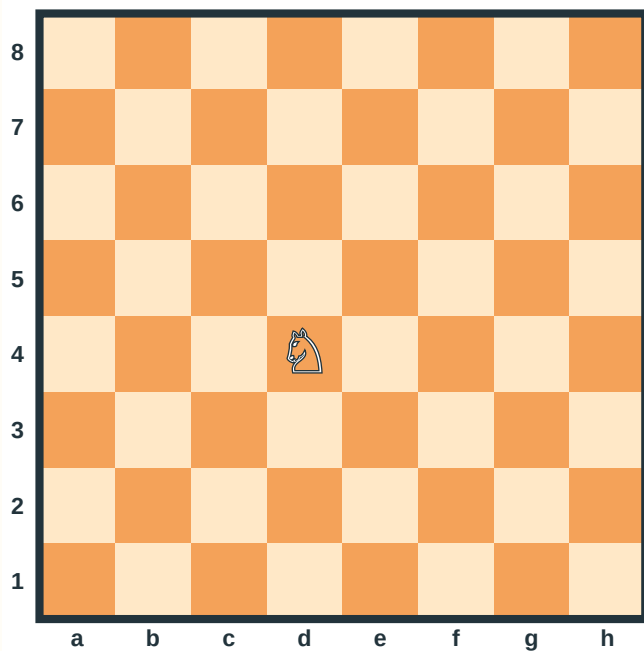


Find the Bishop's Shortest Path

A square maze with a black border. The maze is composed of black lines forming walls. A stick figure is at the top-left corner, and a yellow diamond with a black outline is at the bottom-right corner. The maze has a complex path with many dead ends.

Which Chess Piece Can Reach This Square?

A Knight stands on d4. Circle every square below that the Knight could reach in exactly one move.



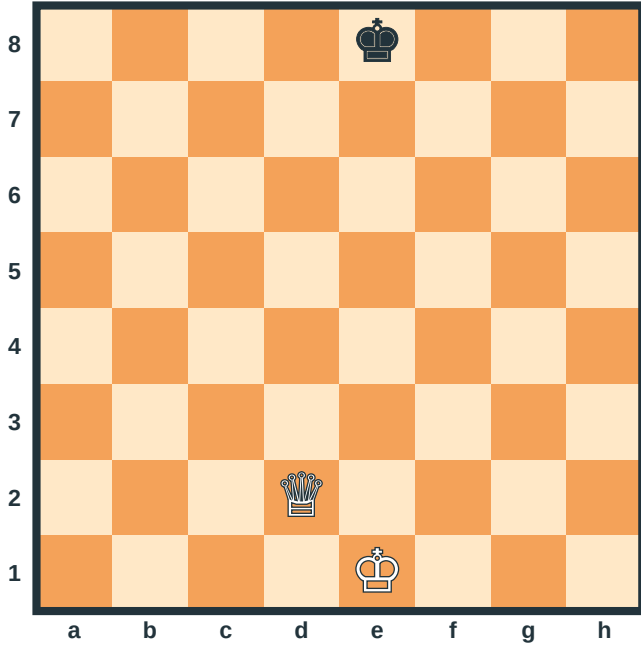
Candidate squares: b3, b5, f3, f5, a1

Write your answer:

.....

Which Piece Should Move First?

Black's king on e8 is not currently in check, but White's Queen on d2 is aiming down the board. If it were White's turn, which piece would you consider moving first to create the biggest threat?

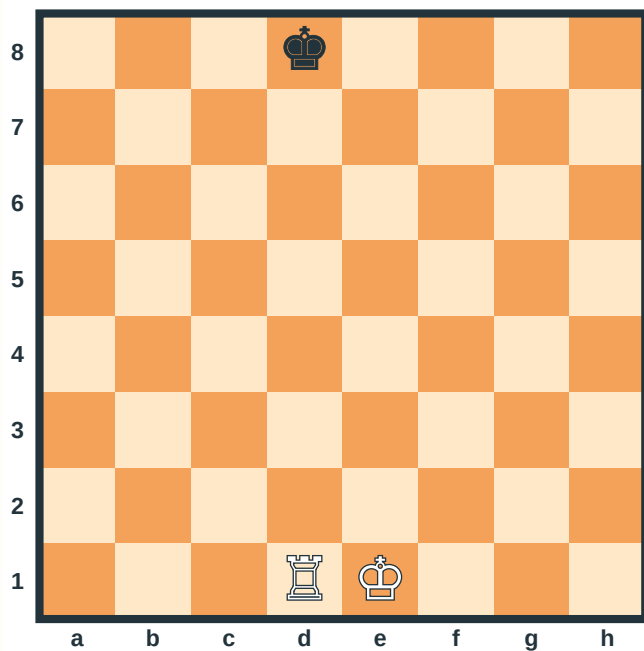


Write your answer:

.....

Which Piece Is Protecting the King?

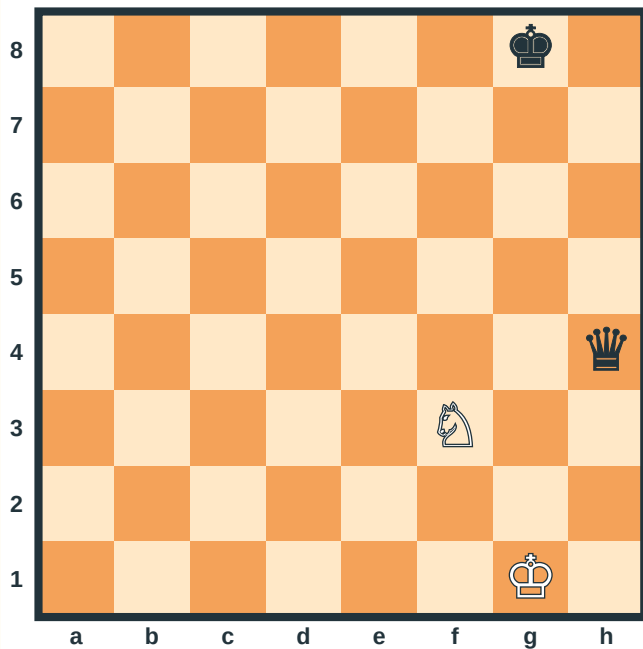
Look at the board. Which White piece stands between the King and any danger coming down the d-file?



Write your answer:

Which Move Wins Material?

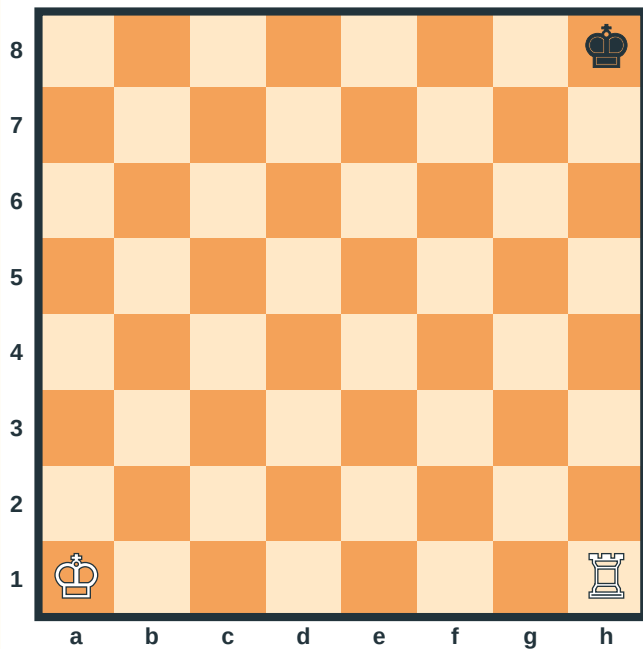
White's Knight is on f3. The Black Queen on h4 is undefended. Can the Knight capture it in one move?



Write your answer:

Which Square Is Attacked?

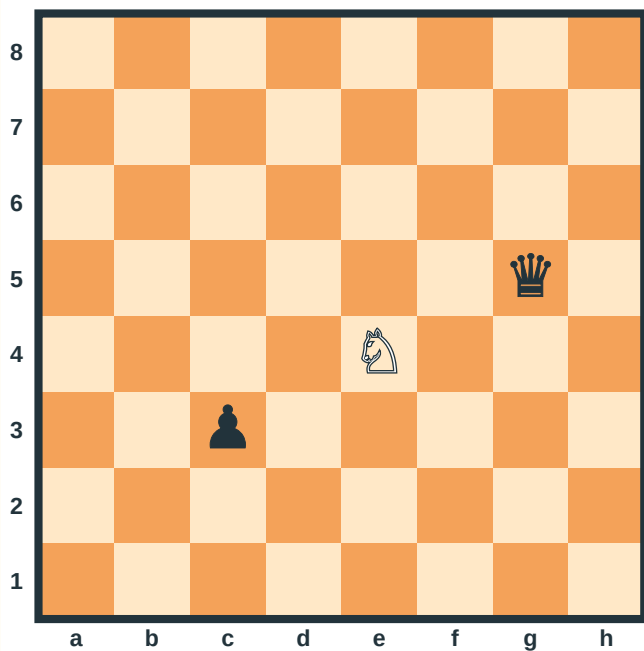
The Rook stands on h1. Name one square on the h-file (other than h1) that the Rook is currently attacking.



Write your answer:

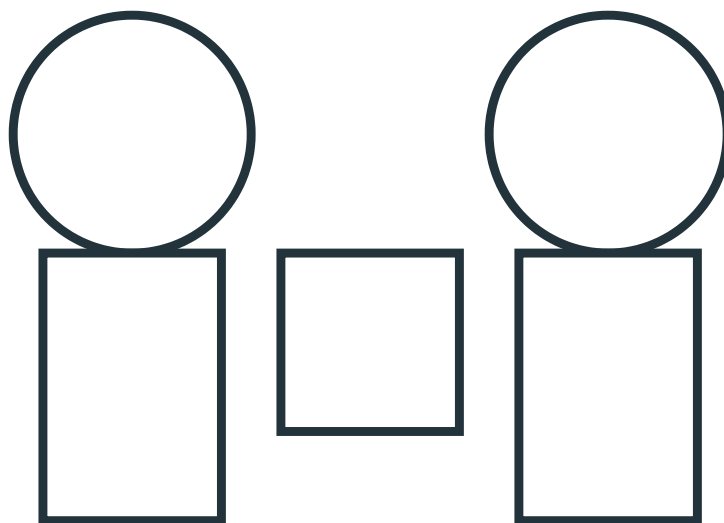
Which Chess Piece Does Not Belong?

Three pieces are shown: a Knight, a Queen and a pawn. If this were a set of "pieces worth 3 points or less," which piece does NOT belong in that group?



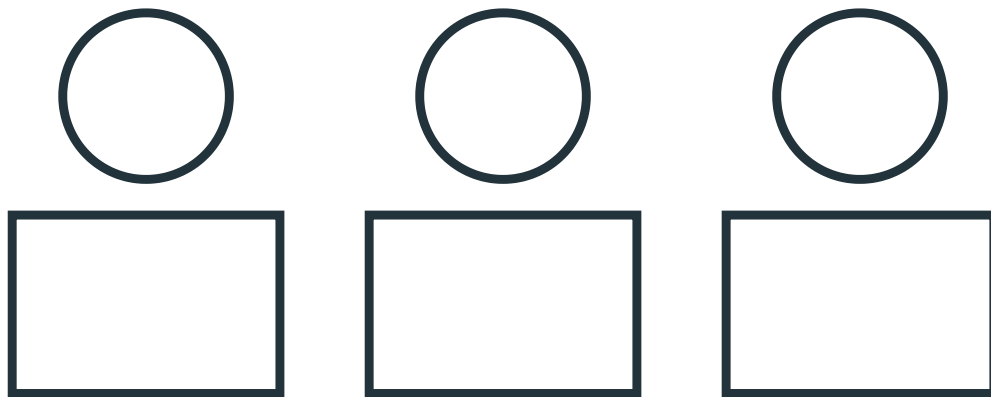
Write your answer:

Children Playing Chess



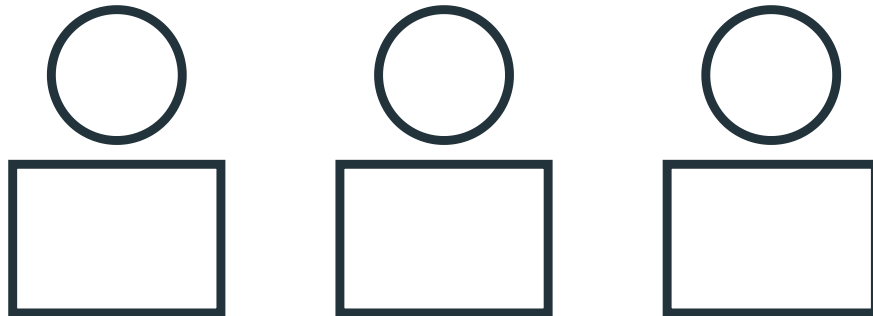
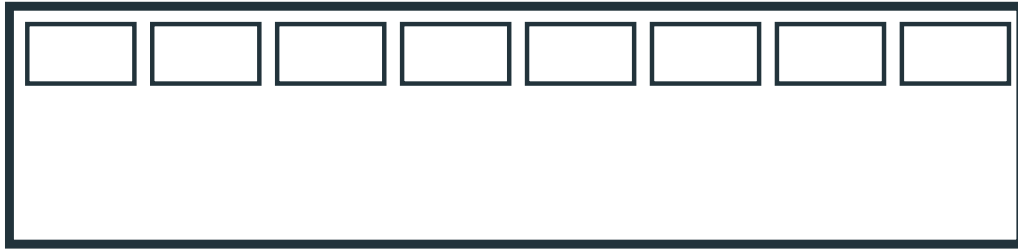
 **Chess Fact:** Chess can be enjoyed by two players of any age — grandparents and grandchildren often play together!

Chess Tournament Scene



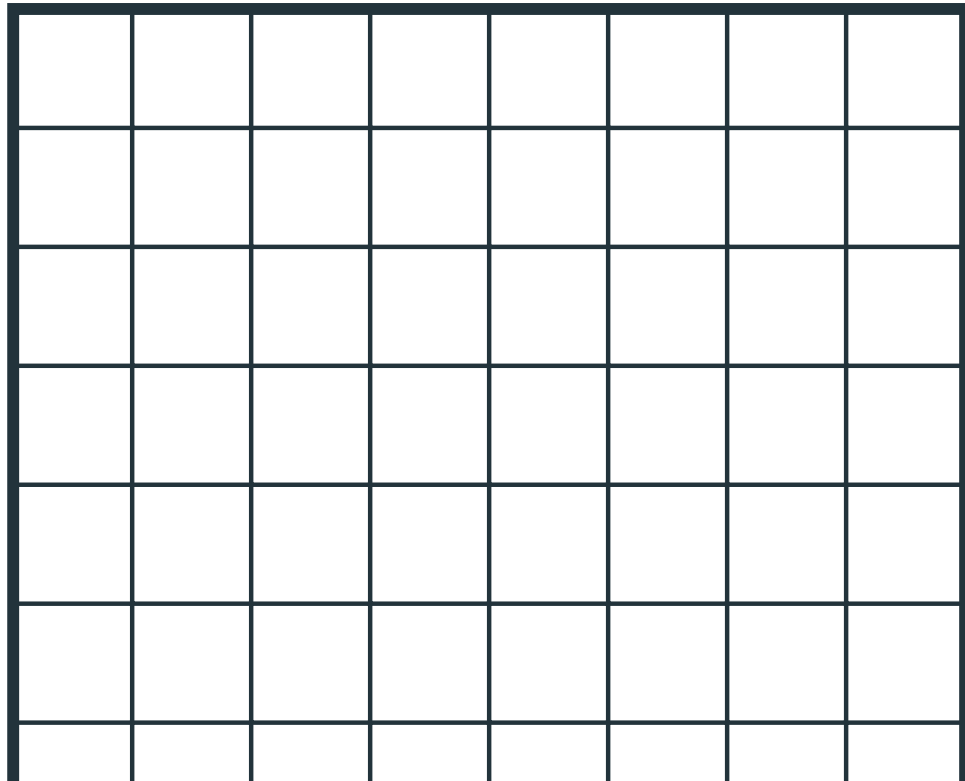
 **Chess Fact:** In a big tournament, many players compete on rows of boards at the very same time.

Chess Classroom



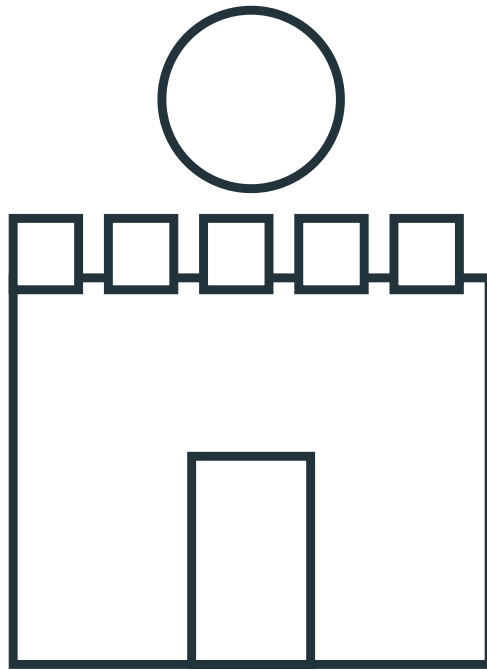
 **Chess Fact:** Many schools around the world now teach chess as part of their activities.

Giant Chessboard



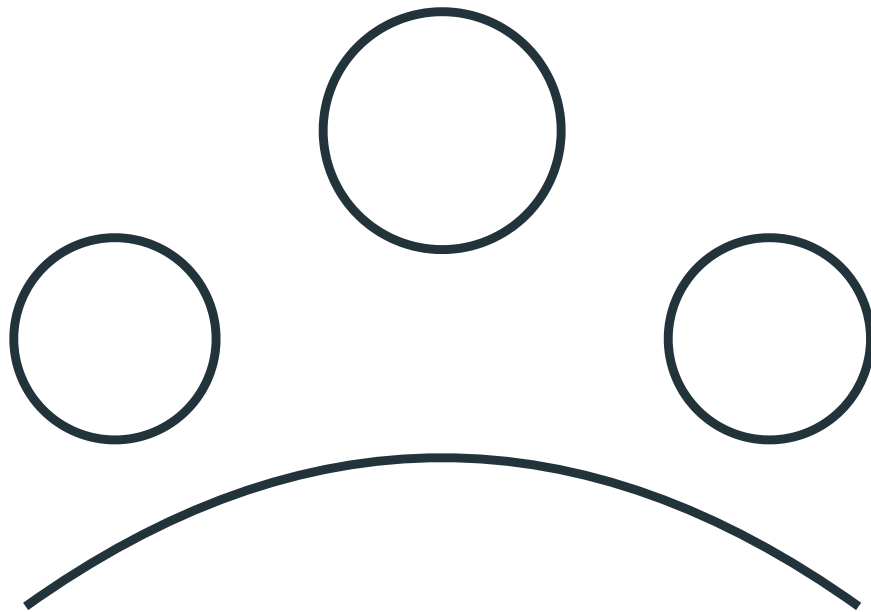
🏆 **Chess Fact:** Some parks have giant chessboards with pieces so big you have to carry them with both hands!

King and Queen's Castle



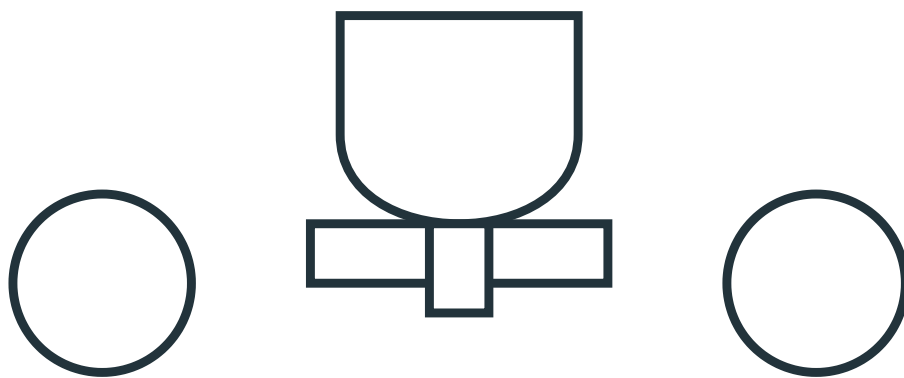
🏆 Chess Fact: The Rook piece is shaped like a castle tower, sometimes called a "castle" for short.

Knight's Adventure



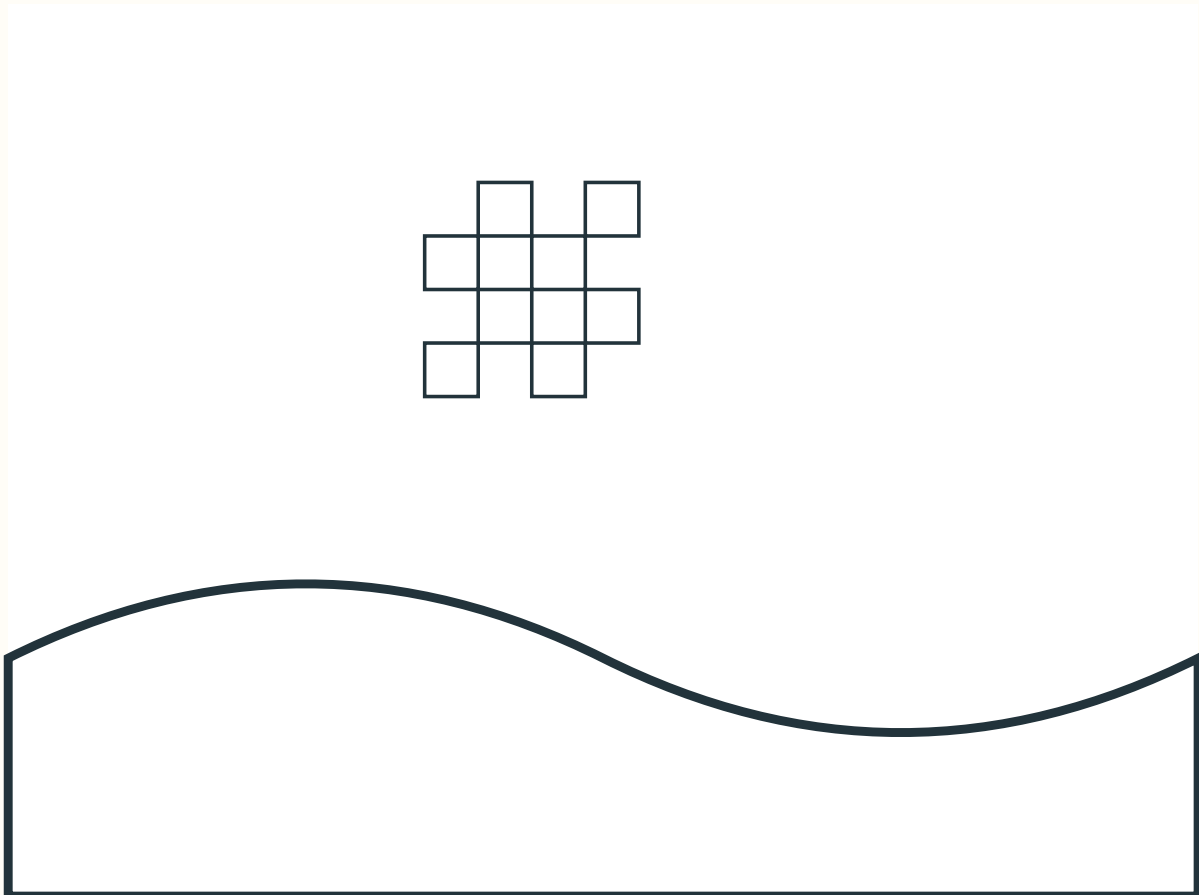
🏆 **Chess Fact:** The Knight is the only piece that moves in an L-shape and can leap over others.

Chess Trophy Celebration



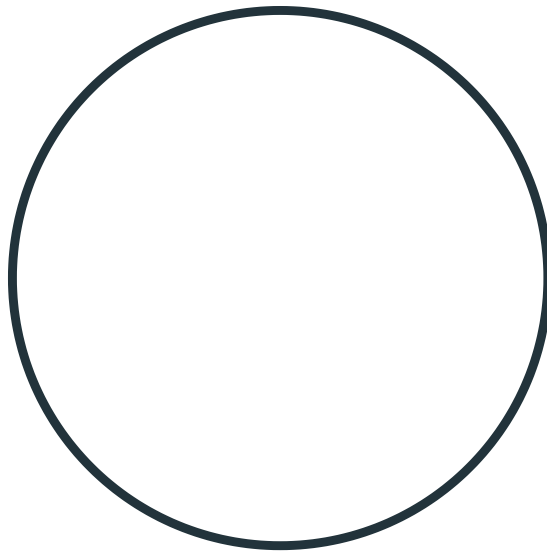
🏆 **Chess Fact:** Winning a chess tournament takes patience, practice and a good deal of clever thinking!

Chessboard Landscape



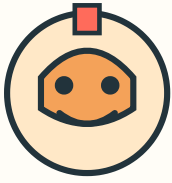
Chess Fact: Chessboards always have 32 light squares and 32 dark squares.

Your Own Chess Creation



 **Chess Fact:** Use your imagination — draw and colour your own chess-themed picture in this space!

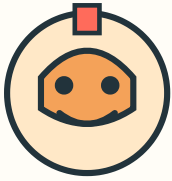
Chapter 1: The Wooden Box



In a small sunny attic, a curious girl named Zara found an old wooden box tucked behind a stack of picture books. Inside, sixty-four little squares were painted onto a folded board, and a bag of carved pieces rattled softly. "What is this game?" Zara whispered. As she opened the box fully, a tiny knight-shaped piece seemed to wink at her in the sunlight. "That," said a small, cheerful voice, "is a chessboard — and I am Sir Knightley!"

Activity: If you found a mysterious box, what do you think might be inside? Draw or write your idea in the space below.

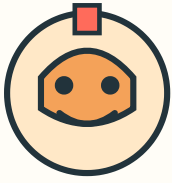
Chapter 2: Meeting the Kingdom



Sir Knightley hopped in his funny L-shaped way and introduced Zara to the whole kingdom: brave King Bram, who always needed protecting; clever Queen Clara, who could glide in every direction; two solid Rooks who guarded the corners like towers; two Bishops who only ever travelled on their own colour of diagonal path; and a row of small but mighty Pawns, standing ready at the front line. "Every piece," said Queen Clara, "has its own special way of moving. Learn them, and you will understand our whole kingdom."

Activity: Can you name one piece from the story and describe how it moves? Write your answer below.

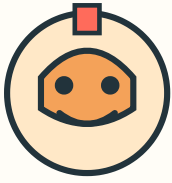
Chapter 3: The Lesson of Slow Thinking



Zara wanted to move her pieces quickly, but Sir Knightley stopped her gently. "In our kingdom, we always pause before we leap," he said. "A wise player looks at the whole board, imagines what might happen next, and only then decides." Zara took a breath, looked carefully at the squares, and noticed something she had missed before — a pawn that could protect her king. "Thinking first," she smiled, "is its own kind of magic."

Activity: Before your next move in a real game, try counting to five in your head first. Did it help you spot something new? Write yes or no and why.

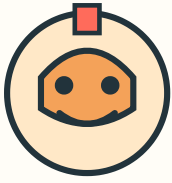
Chapter 4: The Brave Little Pawn



One little pawn named Pip dreamed of reaching the far end of the board. Step by step, square by square, Pip marched forward while the bigger pieces protected the path. It was slow, and sometimes scary, but Pip never gave up. At last, after a long journey, Pip reached the very last rank and — with a flash of light — transformed into a brand-new Queen! "Even the smallest piece," said King Bram, "can become something amazing with patience and courage."

Activity: Pip never gave up on the journey. Write about a time you kept trying at something difficult until you got better at it.

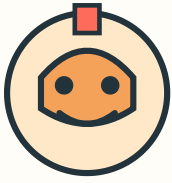
Chapter 5: The Puzzle of the Fork



One afternoon, an opposing knight came galloping in an odd zig-zag pattern and suddenly threatened both King Bram and a Rook at the very same time! "That sneaky move is called a fork," explained Queen Clara. "One piece attacking two targets at once. We must always watch out for the enemy's knights — they can appear from surprising angles." Zara studied the L-shaped hops carefully, determined to spot forks before they happened.

Activity: Look back at the Find the Fork puzzles in this book. In your own words, explain what a fork is.

Chapter 6: A Kingdom of Friends



By the end of her afternoon in the attic, Zara understood that chess was not just about winning — it was about patience, planning, and getting to know each unique piece in the kingdom. She carefully packed the wooden box back up, promising Sir Knightley she would return every day to practise. "Remember," called Queen Clara as the lid closed, "every grand chess master started exactly where you are now — curious, and willing to learn one square at a time."

Activity: Write one new thing you learned about chess from this story, and one thing you still want to learn.

How Much Do You Know About Chess?

1. How many squares are there on a chessboard?

- | | |
|-------|--------|
| A. 32 | B. 48 |
| C. 64 | D. 100 |

2. How many pawns does each player start with?

- | | |
|-------|-------|
| A. 6 | B. 8 |
| C. 10 | D. 16 |

3. Which piece can only move diagonally?

- | | |
|-----------|-----------|
| A. Rook | B. Bishop |
| C. Knight | D. King |

4. Which piece moves in an L-shape?

- | | |
|-----------|----------|
| A. Bishop | B. Queen |
| C. Knight | D. Pawn |

5. How many points is a Queen worth in our counting system?

- | | |
|------|------|
| A. 3 | B. 5 |
| C. 9 | D. 1 |

How Much Do You Know About Chess?

6. What do we call it when the king is under attack and must respond?

- A. Castling
- B. Check
- C. Capture
- D. Stalemate

7. What happens when the king is in check and cannot escape?

- A. Draw
- B. Castling
- C. Checkmate
- D. Promotion

8. Which is the only piece that can jump over other pieces?

- A. Rook
- B. Knight
- C. Bishop
- D. Queen

9. How many ranks (rows) are on a chessboard?

- A. 6
- B. 8
- C. 10
- D. 12

10. How many files (columns) are on a chessboard?

- A. 6
- B. 8
- C. 10
- D. 12

How Much Do You Know About Chess?

11. What is the special move where the King and Rook move together?

- A. Castling
- B. En passant
- C. Promotion
- D. Check

12. Which piece is the most valuable (other than the King)?

- A. Rook
- B. Bishop
- C. Queen
- D. Pawn

13. What is it called when a pawn reaches the last rank and becomes another piece?

- A. Castling
- B. Promotion
- C. Check
- D. Fork

14. A move that attacks two enemy pieces at the same time is called a...

- A. Pin
- B. Fork
- C. Skewer
- D. Draw

15. Which piece starts the game next to the King?

- A. Rook
- B. Bishop
- C. Queen
- D. Knight

How Much Do You Know About Chess?

16. If a Rook (5) captures a Bishop (3), how many points does White gain?

- A. 5
- B. 3
- C. 8
- D. 2

17. How many Knights does each side start with?

- A. 1
- B. 2
- C. 3
- D. 4

18. What is the name for a game that ends with neither side winning?

- A. Checkmate
- B. Draw
- C. Fork
- D. Castling

19. Which square colour is a1 on a standard board?

- A. Light
- B. Dark
- C. Red
- D. Green

20. What should you always do before moving a piece?

- A. Move quickly
- B. Think ahead
- C. Ignore the board
- D. Copy your opponent

Answers & Explanations

Piece Brain Games

Match the Piece to Its Name: Each chess piece icon matches its own name (King, Queen, Rook, Bishop, Knight, Pawn).

Match the Piece to Its Movement: Each piece matches its official movement rule described earlier in the Meet the Pieces section.

Which Piece Is Missing?: The missing piece is the Pawn.

Count the Chess Pieces: There are 5 Knights.

Find the Different Piece: The odd one out is the Pawn — every other piece was a Queen.

Chess Piece Memory Challenge: King, Queen, Pawn, Knight, Bishop

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Which Square Can It Reach?: Reachable square(s): A, B.

Piece Movement Recap Quiz: Bishop, Knight, Queen, King, Pawn, Rook

Chess Puzzles

Puzzle 1 (Find the Checkmate, Easy): The rook moves all the way down the open a-file to a8. The black king cannot escape because its own pawns on f7, g7 and h7 block every escape square. This is called a back-rank checkmate.

Puzzle 2 (Find the Checkmate, Easy): The queen slides along the 7th rank to g7. The white king on g6 protects the queen, so the black king cannot capture it, and g8/h7 are also covered by the queen. Checkmate!

Puzzle 3 (Find the Checkmate, Hard): The rook swings all the way over to h1, lining up with the king on the open h-file. The black king cannot step to g8 because the White knight on e7 guards it, cannot step to h7 because the rook itself controls the whole h-file, and g7 is blocked by its own pawn. Checkmate!

Puzzle 4 (Find the Checkmate, Hard): Just like in an earlier puzzle, the queen swings across the 7th rank to g7. The White king on g6 protects her, so the black king cannot capture, and every escape square is covered. The black knight on b4 is just a distraction — it cannot help its king at all. Checkmate!

Answers & Explanations

Puzzle 5 (Find the Check, Easy): The rook slides along the 4th rank onto the d-file. Since the black king is also on the d-file with nothing in between, the rook now attacks it directly. That is check!

Puzzle 6 (Find the Check, Medium): The bishop moves along its diagonal to e5. From there it sits on the same diagonal as the black king on g7 (e5-f6-g7), so it gives check.

Puzzle 7 (Find the Capture, Easy): The knight can jump to g5 and capture the undefended black queen — a fantastic trade for White!

Puzzle 8 (Find the Capture, Medium): The bishop travels the long diagonal from a2 all the way to g8, capturing the undefended black rook.

Puzzle 9 (Find the Attacker, Easy): The knight on e5 attacks g6 (an L-shaped knight move). The rook on h1 does not attack g6 at all. The knight is the attacker — and it can capture the queen!

Puzzle 10 (Find the Attacker, Medium): The bishop on g2 sits on the long diagonal that runs through c6, so the bishop is the attacker. The rook on f1 only attacks squares on the f-file and 1st rank — it has nothing to do with c6.

Answers & Explanations

Puzzle 11 (Find the Defender, Easy): The knight on b5 defends d4 — if Black captures the pawn, White can recapture with the knight.

Puzzle 12 (Find the Defender, Medium): The queen on f4 defends the pawn directly (right behind it). The rook on f1 also supports the file, but the queen is the first, direct defender.

Puzzle 13 (Find the Fork, Medium): Nc7+ is a royal fork! The knight gives check to the king on e8 and also attacks the rook on a8 at the same time. After the king moves away, White plays Nxa8 and wins the rook.

Puzzle 14 (Find the Fork, Hard): The knight jumps to e5. From there it attacks the queen on d7 and the rook on f7 at the same time — both are an L-shaped knight move away. Black can only save one piece, so White wins material. Knights are famous for double attacks like this because of their unusual L-shaped move.

Puzzle 15 (Find the Pin, Medium): The rook on e1 pins the knight on e5 to the black king on e8 along the open e-file — if the knight ever moved, it would expose its own king to check. Since nothing protects the knight, White simply plays Rxe5 and wins it for free.

Puzzle 16 (Find the Pin, Hard): The bishop on b2 sits on the long a1-h8 diagonal, pinning the knight on f6 to the black king on g8. Since the knight cannot move off this diagonal and nothing protects it, White plays Bxf6 and wins it for free.

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Puzzle 17 (Find the Skewer, Medium): Ra1+ lines the rook up with the king on a8, with the queen on a4 sitting on the same file behind it. The king must move out of check, and then Rxa4 wins the queen — a skewer! In a skewer, the more valuable piece is attacked first and forced to move, uncovering a smaller piece behind it.

Puzzle 18 (Find the Skewer, Hard): Rd1+ lines the rook up with the king on d8, with the queen on d5 also sitting on that file behind the king. The king must move out of check, and then Rxd5 wins the queen — a classic skewer.

Puzzle 19 (Find the Discovered Attack, Hard): Nxb6+ steps the knight off the d-file and captures the black queen at the same time! The rook on d1, which was hiding behind the knight, now gives check straight down the file to the king on d8. This is called a discovered check — moving one piece reveals an attack from a piece standing behind it.

Puzzle 20 (Find the Discovered Attack, Hard): When the knight steps aside to c6, it clears the long diagonal, and the bishop on b2 now gives check to the king on g7 all by itself. This is a discovered check — and the knight is free to attack or capture something else at the same time.

Chess Maths

Addition Q1: 6

Addition Q2: 12

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Addition Q3: 2

Addition Q4: 6

Addition Q5: 12

Addition Q6: 18

Addition (2) Q1: 10

Addition (2) Q2: 6

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Addition (2) Q3: 6

Addition (2) Q4: 6

Addition (2) Q5: 4

Addition (2) Q6: 6

Subtraction Q1: 2

Subtraction Q2: 2

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Subtraction Q3: 4

Subtraction Q4: 4

Subtraction Q5: 4

Subtraction Q6: 0

Subtraction (2) Q1: 0

Subtraction (2) Q2: 0

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Subtraction (2) Q3: 2

Subtraction (2) Q4: 6

Subtraction (2) Q5: 2

Subtraction (2) Q6: 0

Multiplication Q1: 12

Multiplication Q2: 9

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Multiplication Q3: 9

Multiplication Q4: 20

Multiplication Q5: 9

Multiplication Q6: 27

Multiplication (2) Q1: 20

Multiplication (2) Q2: 18

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Multiplication (2) Q3: 20

Multiplication (2) Q4: 12

Multiplication (2) Q5: 12

Multiplication (2) Q6: 6

Counting Q1: 64

Counting Q2: 64

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Counting Q3: 64

Counting Q4: 64

Counting Q5: 64

Counting (2) Q1: 5

Counting (2) Q2: 9

Counting (2) Q3: 8

Answers & Explanations

Counting (2) Q4: 10

Counting (2) Q5: 11

Word Problems Q1: 8

Word Problems Q2: 3

Word Problems Q3: Priya gained lost 1 points

Word Problems Q4: 5

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Word Problems Q5: 8

Word Problems (2) Q1: 8

Word Problems (2) Q2: 5

Word Problems (2) Q3: Dev gained lost 1 points

Word Problems (2) Q4: 3

Word Problems (2) Q5: 8

Answers & Explanations

Word Problems (3) Q1: 8

Word Problems (3) Q2: 4

Word Problems (3) Q3: Mia gained lost 1 points

Word Problems (3) Q4: 6

Word Problems (3) Q5: 8

Coordinates Q1: d8

Answers & Explanations

Coordinates Q2: d

Coordinates Q3: 1

Coordinates Q4: h1

Coordinates Q5: a

Coordinates Q6: 4

Coordinates (2) Q1: c6

Answers & Explanations

Coordinates (2) Q2: d

Coordinates (2) Q3: 3

Coordinates (2) Q4: b7

Coordinates (2) Q5: d

Coordinates (2) Q6: 7

Coordinates (3) Q1: c5

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Coordinates (3) Q2: h

Coordinates (3) Q3: 1

Coordinates (3) Q4: c1

Coordinates (3) Q5: c

Coordinates (3) Q6: 4

Brain Games

Pattern Recognition: Next shape: square (■)

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Odd One Out: Position 2 is different (star).

Shape Matching: Match each left-hand shape to the identical shape on the right (diamond, triangle, star, circle, square).

Number Sequences: 12 (the pattern adds 2 each time)

Simple Logic Q1: Black

Simple Logic Q2: Yes

Simple Logic Q3: Yes

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Shape Memory Challenge: diamond, circle, square, square, triangle, circle

Spot the Difference: Row 4, column 4 (counting from the top-left) is different.

Counting Challenge: 7

Direction Challenge: The piece ends up 2 square(s) West and 1 square(s) South of where it started.

Visual Observation: 6

Strategy Challenge Q1: Trading for the Queen (9 points) is much better — you gain more value.

Answers & Explanations

Strategy Challenge Q2: The 9-point coin — it is worth the most.

What Comes Next?: triangle, then square (the pattern repeats every 3 shapes).

Reasoning Q1: Tic-tac-toe

Reasoning Q2: The third friend (whoever is not Arjun or Priya)

Reasoning Q3: A light square

Odd One Out: Position 3 is different (star).

Answers & Explanations

Chess Logic Challenges

Which Chess Piece Can Reach This Square?: b3, b5, f3, f5

Which Piece Should Move First?: The Queen — it is the most powerful piece and can create threats from a distance.

Which Piece Is Protecting the King?: The Rook on d1 blocks the d-file in front of any attack coming from that direction.

Which Move Wins Material?: Yes — Nxh4 wins the undefended Queen!

Which Square Is Attacked?: Any empty square on the h-file between h1 and h8, for example h2, h3, h4, h5, h6, h7 or h8 (until the path is blocked).

Which Chess Piece Does Not Belong?: The Queen does not belong — it is worth 9 points, while the Knight (3) and pawn (1) are both worth 3 points or less.

Answers & Explanations

Chess Quiz

Question 1: C. 64

Question 2: B. 8

Question 3: B. Bishop

Question 4: C. Knight

Question 5: C. 9

Question 6: B. Check

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Question 7: C. Checkmate

Question 8: B. Knight

Question 9: B. 8

Question 10: B. 8

Question 11: A. Castling

Question 12: C. Queen

ANSWER KEY

Answers & Explanations

Question 13: B. Promotion

Question 14: B. Fork

Question 15: C. Queen

Question 16: B. 3

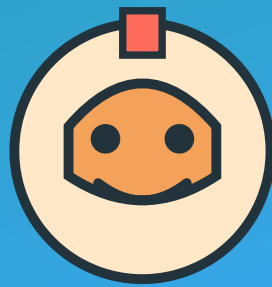
Question 17: B. 2

Question 18: B. Draw

Answers & Explanations

Question 19: B. Dark

Question 20: B. Think ahead



Thank You for Playing!

We hope you enjoyed every puzzle, colouring page, maze and brain game in this book. Keep practising, keep thinking, and keep having fun with chess!

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